

THE BRAIN BRAKE

the animator read through

Presented by Manan Periwal · animated by Kristijan Kauri ■ · Breakthrough Junior Challenge 2026

Every frame in the film, in order, with what it is, what it means and how it moves. Built from the catalogue, so it cannot drift from the live page. The site is always current; this is the copy you print and mark up.

markoboskoauville.github.io/ANIMATOR_COLLABORATION

FIVE THINGS THAT DECIDE EVERY SHOT

BEFORE HE CLOSES HIS EYES, THINGS ARRIVE.

The world manifests out of the paper, part by part, by frottage: a shape rubs through as though something under the sheet is being taken. Nothing slides in from the side, nothing fades up. If a thing needs to appear, it is rubbed on. This is the whole grammar of the first half and it never varies.

AFTER HE CLOSES HIS EYES, NOTHING ARRIVES. WE MOVE.

Every transition is a passage through a surface. Through a door, into a throat, past a lens, into the paper itself. THERE IS NO CUT ANYWHERE AFTER PHASE 5. If a shot seems to need one, the answer is a surface, not a cut.

GOLD MEANS FOUND.

Gold is not the key's colour, it is what the key means once he has it. So the whole passage is graphite even though it is made of keys, because he has not found it yet. The first gold is at Coach Brain's neck. The last is the key falling out of the sky. There is no third.

THE SIGNS ARE NEVER EXPLAINED.

A shape raised in clay tells you what is behind a door. Nobody says so, no camera move points at it, no music underlines it. By the fourth door the audience is reading them without having been taught, and that is why the key door works.

HE IS REAL. THE INSIDE OF HIM IS DRAWN.

Manan is photographic, in monochrome, everywhere he appears. The house of the body, the vortex and Coach Brain are pencil. Do not draw him and do not colour him.



THE BRAIN BRAKE

THE CENTRAL GOVERNOR THEORY

PHASE 0.0

0-0-TITLE-v1

0-0-TITLE-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Title card. Front of both versions.

HOW IT MOVES

Hold. The title rubs itself onto the paper by frottage, edge first, and is never typed on. Nothing else moves.



PHASE 1.0

1-0-B-v1

1-0-B-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 2 of 3. Close on the feet, which say runner faster than a face does and keep the face back for shot 1.1. One shoe landed flat and heavy with dust lifting, the other dragging low and barely clearing the ground. It also sets the film's method: look closely at the thing everyone thinks they already understand. NOTE: the shoes are modern trainers rather than the 1923 racing shoes on the character sheet. Cheap to correct if the period matters.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.0

1-0-A-v2

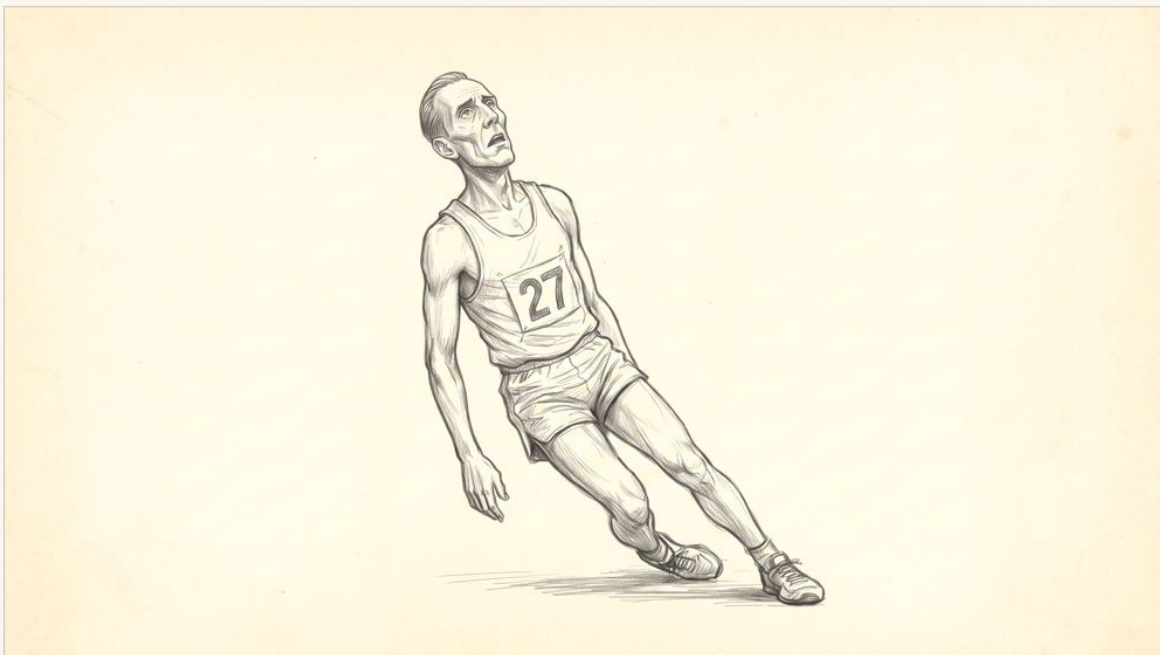
1-0-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 1 of 3. THE FILM OPENS HERE. He is tiny and alone in a corridor of trees, the road running away to nothing. Same avenue and viewpoint as shot 1.2b on purpose: this is the place before there is anything to see in it. The figure carries the collapse pose from V7 shot 1.2, so the wide and the close say the same thing.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.0

1-0-C-v2

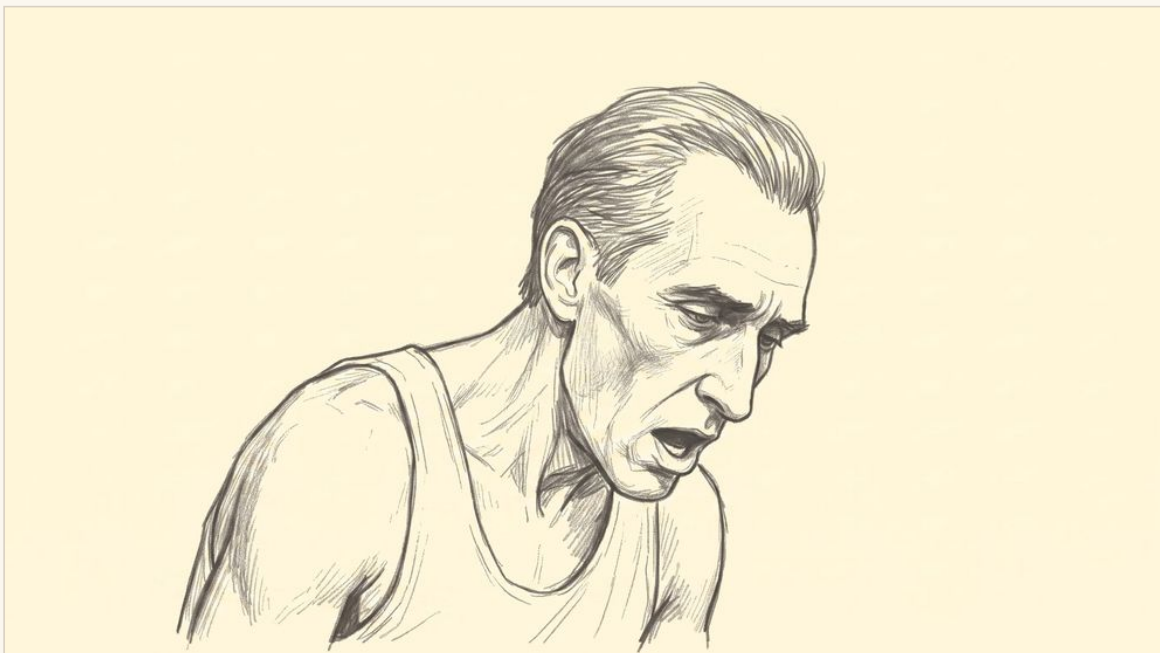
1-0-C-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 3 of 3, AND HALF OF THE FILM'S BOOKEND. His legs have gone from under him and he is falling backwards, one leg folded beneath him, arms dead at his sides, head tipped back. THE POSE COMES FROM V7 SHOT 1.2 at Baba's instruction, replacing an invented crouch that read as neither running nor collapsing. Cut against shot 1.3 phase 1 at the far end of the scene: same man, same frame, one destroyed and one fresh. Frame rate here is the slowest in the film, two to three a second.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.1

1-1-v11

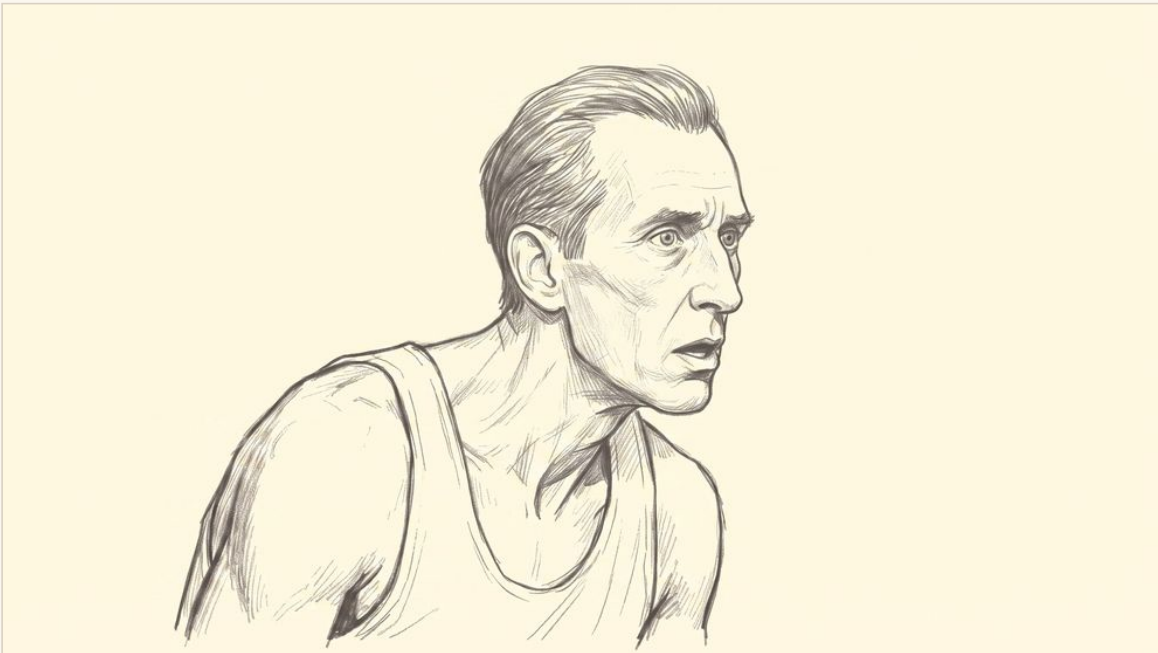
1-1-v11.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 1 of 3. He is finished, and he believes he still has ten kilometres to run, which is why the exhaustion is total. Head down, eyes on the ground, mouth open. THE CAMERA DOES NOT MOVE across these three: same head size, same position, same three quarter angle throughout. The emotion changes inside the shot without a cut, so this is the start of one continuous move, not three separate shots. Frame rate here is the slowest in the film, two to three a second, barely turning over.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.1

1-1-v15

1-1-v15.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 2 of 3. The neck straightening, the chin off the chest, the eyes coming up off the ground to the middle distance. Still breathing hard. This is the middle of the move and the audience does not yet know why he is rising.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.1

1-1-v18

1-1-v18.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 3 of 3. He has seen it. The whole face relaxes: brow smooth, eyes resting easy on something far ahead and out of frame, the corners of the mouth just lifted. Relief arriving, not shock. End the shot here and cut. The audience asks why he changed, and shot 1.2b answers. He is looking OUT of frame on purpose: if he looked at us the cut would not work.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.3

1-3-A-v1

1-3-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

PHASE 1 of the run. Same pose, size and position as the last muscle frame, with skin and clothing on: the far end of a DISSOLVE, not a cut. Mean pixel difference between the two is 9.7 of 255. From here the strobe has dropped and the animation runs at 8 to 10 frames a second.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.3

1-3-B-v5

1-3-B-v5.png

WHAT IT IS

PHASE 2 of the run. Two more attempts at a fully airborne mid-stride were abandoned after four rejects, all of which came back with three legs. Kristijan can interpolate the mid-stride from these two ends, which is what an animator does anyway. If a drawn airborne beat is wanted, reference/RUNNER_STRIDE_AIRBORNE-v2.jpg is the correct pose in the right hand.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.5

1-5-v1

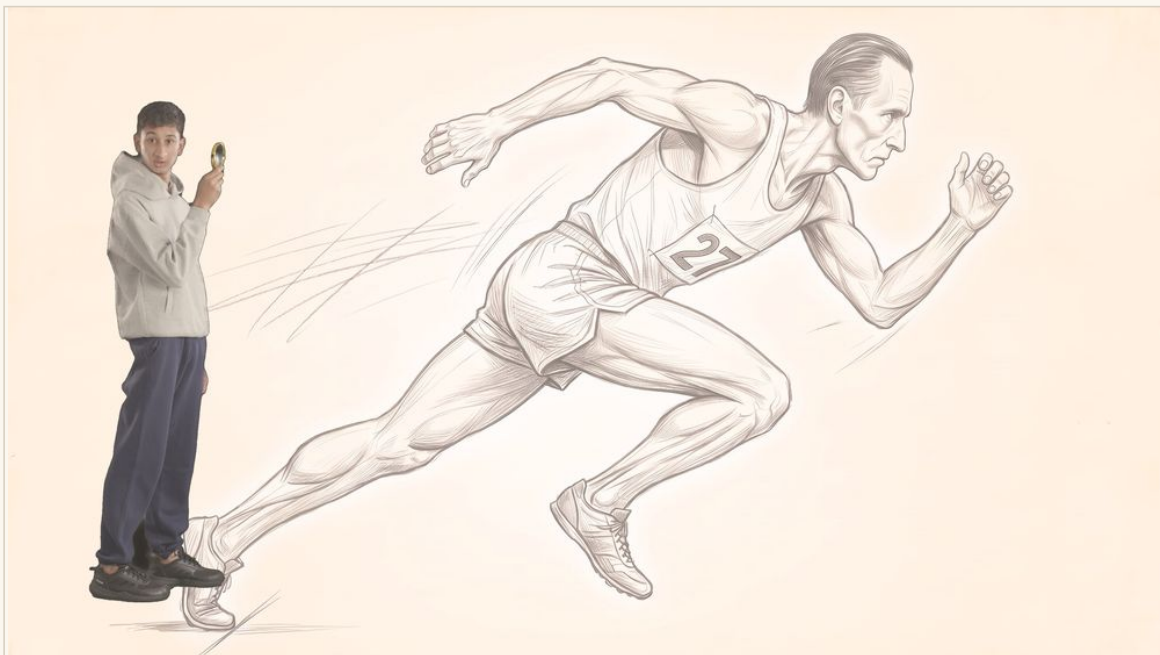
1-5-v1.jpg

WHAT IT IS

MANAN WALKS IN. The runner is still going and the boy steps into the drawn world beside him, magnifying glass up. The film's first crossing of its two worlds: anything real is a photograph, anything thought is a pencil drawing, and here they stand in one frame. Both figures are on the same ground line and the runner is the smaller of the two, which is what makes the boy the subject and the runner the thing being examined.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.5

1-4-C-v2

1-4-C-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

THE SAME SHOT WITH THE REAL MANAN. Built from the keyed footage rather than generated: the black backdrop was keyed here by flooding from the frame edge, so his dark hair and black shoes survive intact, then graded warm and lifted toward the cream so he sits in the drawn world instead of on top of it. The generated frame beside it is still the reference for composition. Choose between them. ON THE SCENE AND BREAKDOWN PAGES ONLY, not on the front page storyboard: the generated version stands in there because it reads finished at a glance, and this one is the working material.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.6

1-6-v1

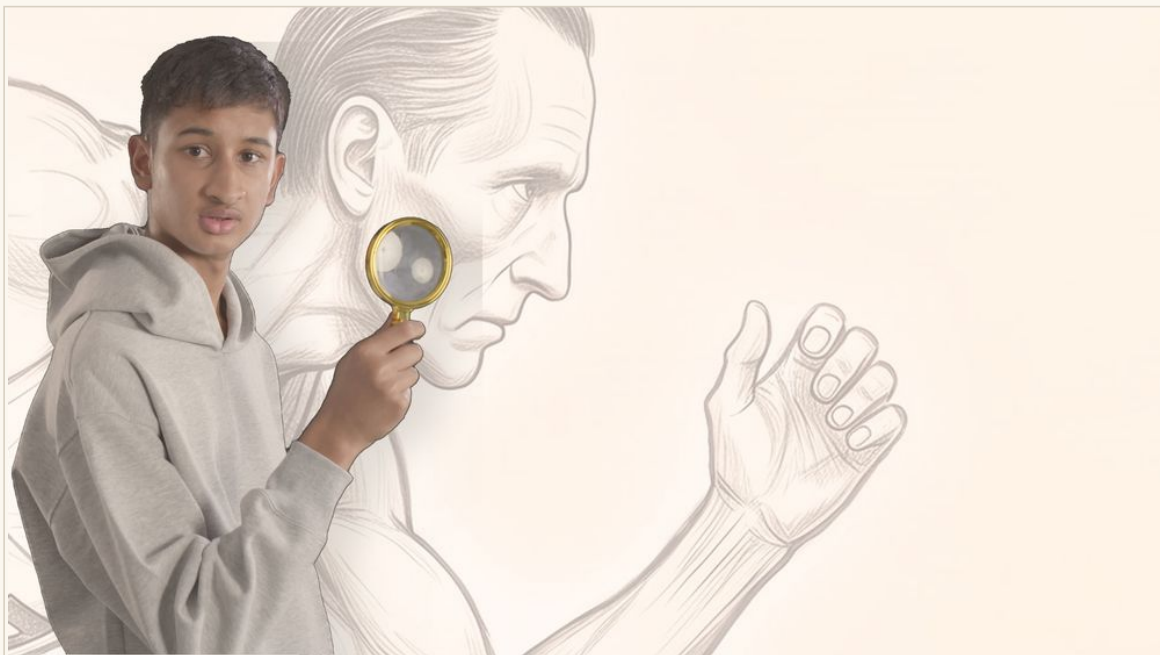
1-6-v1.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HE TURNS TO US. Pushed in. Manan holds the glass and the runner is now a pale sketch beside his head, the same man drawn small and faint. He speaks to camera over it. The contrast drops as we push in, so the drawn world recedes exactly as the real one takes over.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.6

1-4-D-v3

1-4-D-v3.png

WHAT IT IS

THE SAME SHOT WITH THE REAL MANAN. The runner behind him is not a new drawing, it is the previous shot zoomed in and faded back, so the push-in is continuous and the contrast falls as we move closer. Real keyed footage, graded to the paper. Choose between this and the generated one beside it. ON THE SCENE AND BREAKDOWN PAGES ONLY, not on the front page storyboard: the generated version stands in there because it reads finished at a glance, and this one is the working material.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 2.0

V7_5_5_road

V7_5_5_road.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 2.0

2-0-HERO-v1

2-0-HERO-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 2.1

V7_5_1_bike

V7_5_1_bike.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 2.2

5_5_LIVE

5_5_LIVE.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 3.0

3-0-A-v2

3-0-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

Off the storyboard, 31.8.2026. PHASE 3 WAS SHOT AND THE FOOTAGE IS USED. A drawn Manan does not belong on the page when a real one exists: he is a photograph everywhere else in the bicycle sequence and drawing him here contradicts the film's founding law. Kept in the catalogue as framing reference only.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 3.5

SHOT_PANA6223_00_00_14_00_G

SHOT_PANA6223_00_00_14_00_G.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 3.6

SHOT_PANA6227_00_00_06_00_G

SHOT_PANA6227_00_00_06_00_G.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 3.7

SHOT_PANA6229_00_00_06_00_G

SHOT_PANA6229_00_00_06_00_G.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 3.8

V7_5_6_racing

V7_5_6_racing.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 3.9

V7_5_4_idea_lands

V7_5_4_idea_lands.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 4.0

V7_5_7_the_wall

V7_5_7_the_wall.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 4.0

4-0-HERO-v1

4-0-HERO-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 4.1

V7_5_3_beat_it

V7_5_3_beat_it.jpg

WHAT IT IS

Off the storyboard, 1.9.2026. This is a drawing sitting in a live action phase alongside real footage of the same beat, which tells the animator to draw something that was already shot. Kept in the catalogue as early reference only.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 4.2

5_7_LIVE

5_7_LIVE.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 5.0

V7_5_8_eyes_closed

V7_5_8_eyes_closed.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 5.0

5-0-HERO-v1

5-0-HERO-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 5.1

V7_8_1_breathing

V7_8_1_breathing.jpg

WHAT IT IS

Off the storyboard, 1.9.2026, same reason as V7_5_3_beat_it. A drawing in a live action phase beside real footage of the same beat. Found by measuring coloured pixels across all three live phases rather than by eye: 2.4 per cent against 62 to 92 for every photograph around it.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 5.2

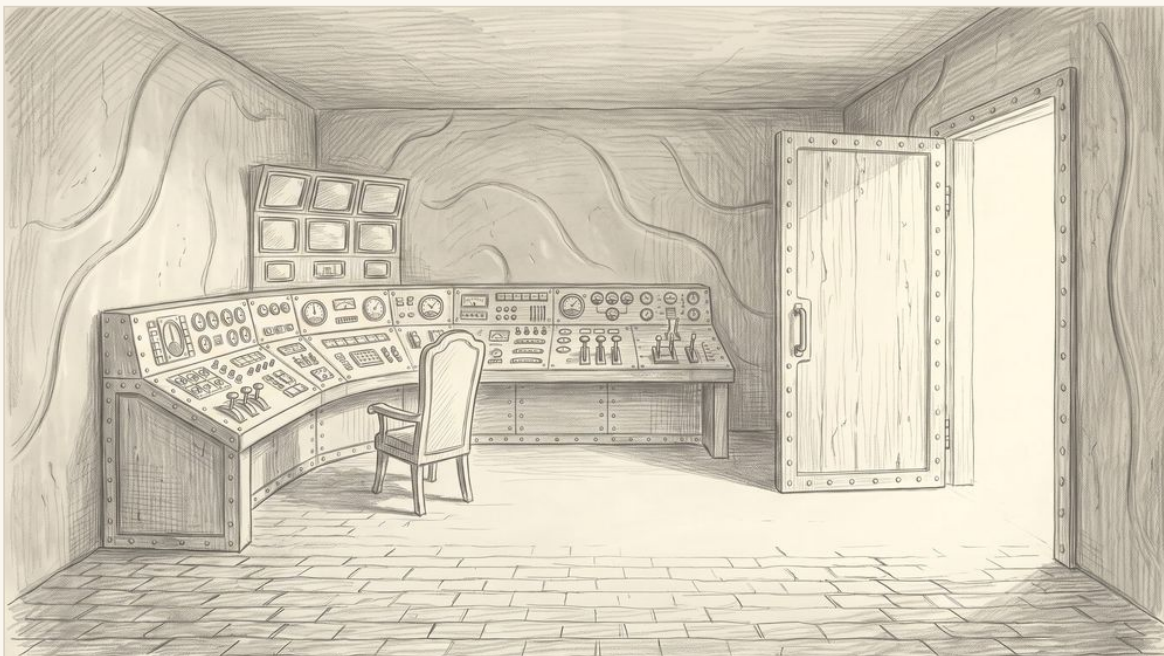
5_8_LIVE

5_8_LIVE.jpg

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 6.3

6-3-A-v2

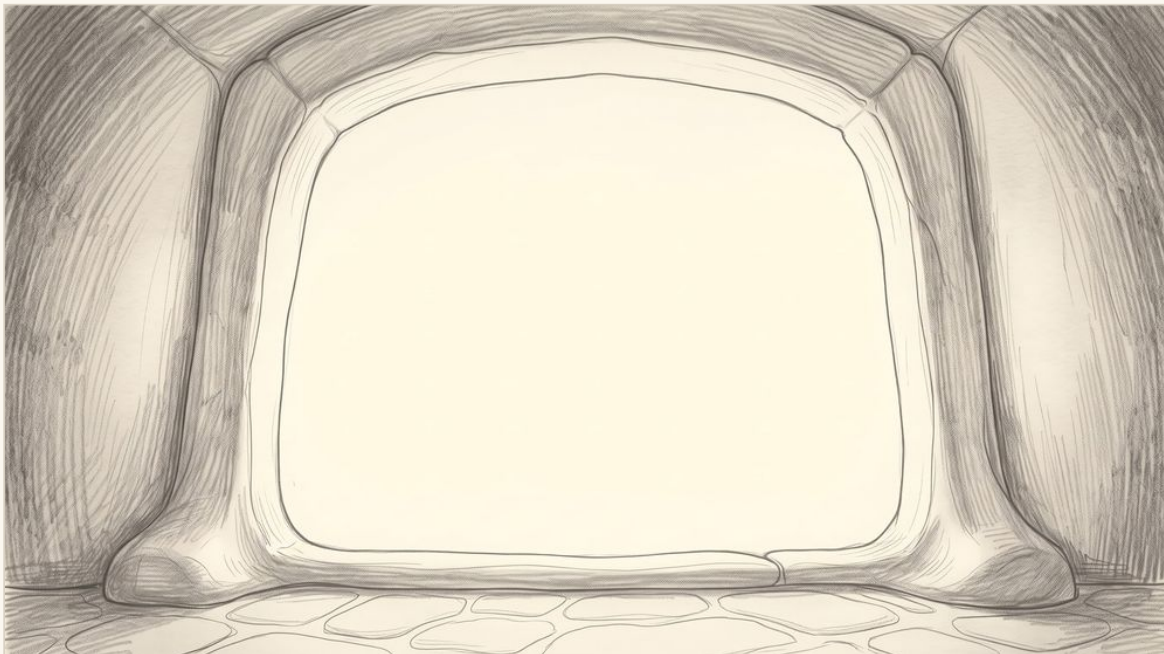
6-3-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

THE CONTROL ROOM, the end of the corridor and the deepest room in the body. A plain rectangular room, flat ceiling, square corners, worn flagstones, and the corridor door standing open on the right with the light still coming through it. THE WALLS ARE SMOOTHED GREY CLAY with shallow winding grooves pressed into them, low and quiet, with long calm stretches between: brainish, not a brain. v1 tried full relief on walls and ceiling and came back a cave. The chair is empty on purpose, this is the room before Coach Brain turns around. GANESHA IS NOT IN THIS FRAME. He is a hand's height in a room sized shot and three attempts failed to hold him, so he lives on the object sheet instead and gets composited.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 7.0

7-0-A-v2

7-0-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 8.0

The corridor, the doors carry shapes

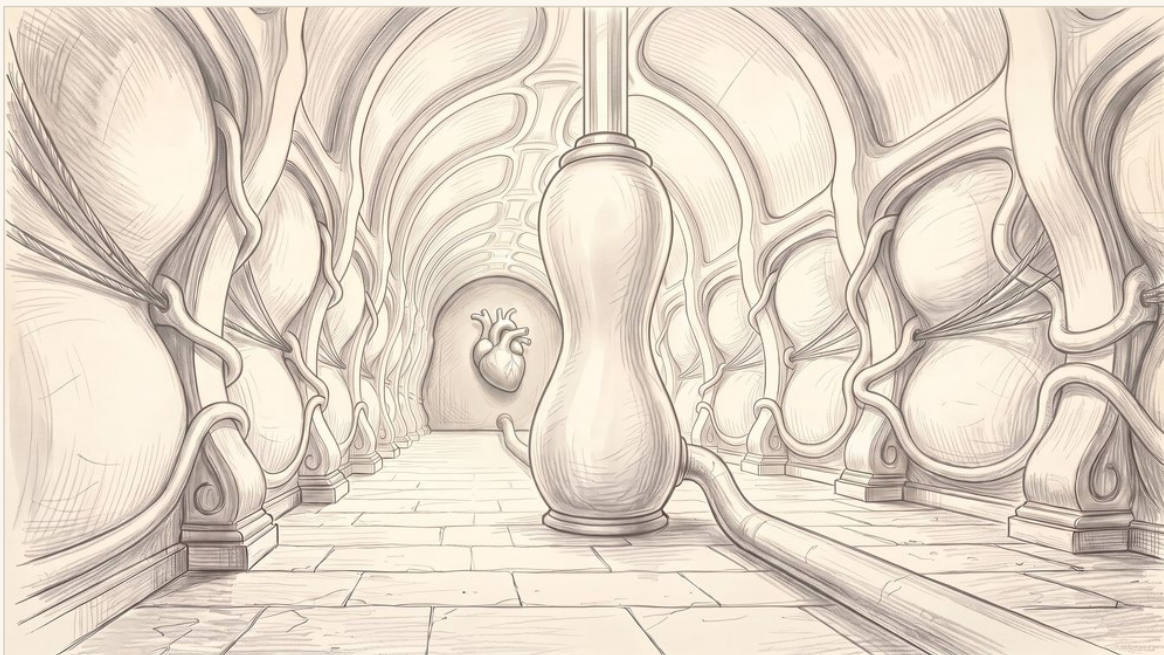
8-0-A-v5.png

WHAT IT IS

The written plaques are gone. Each door swells outward into the shape of what is behind it, moulded in the same white clay as the door. A word excludes anybody who does not read English and does not survive translation; a raised shape is read by the body. This is the frame that teaches the audience to read the doors, so everything after it depends on it. Supersedes v4.

HOW IT MOVES

Slow push straight down the corridor, constant speed, no easing at either end. The doors pass. DO NOT linger on any one of them: the audience must learn that the bumps mean something without being told to look. The far door at the vanishing point stays centred.



PHASE 8.1

The bellows hall, the heart door beyond

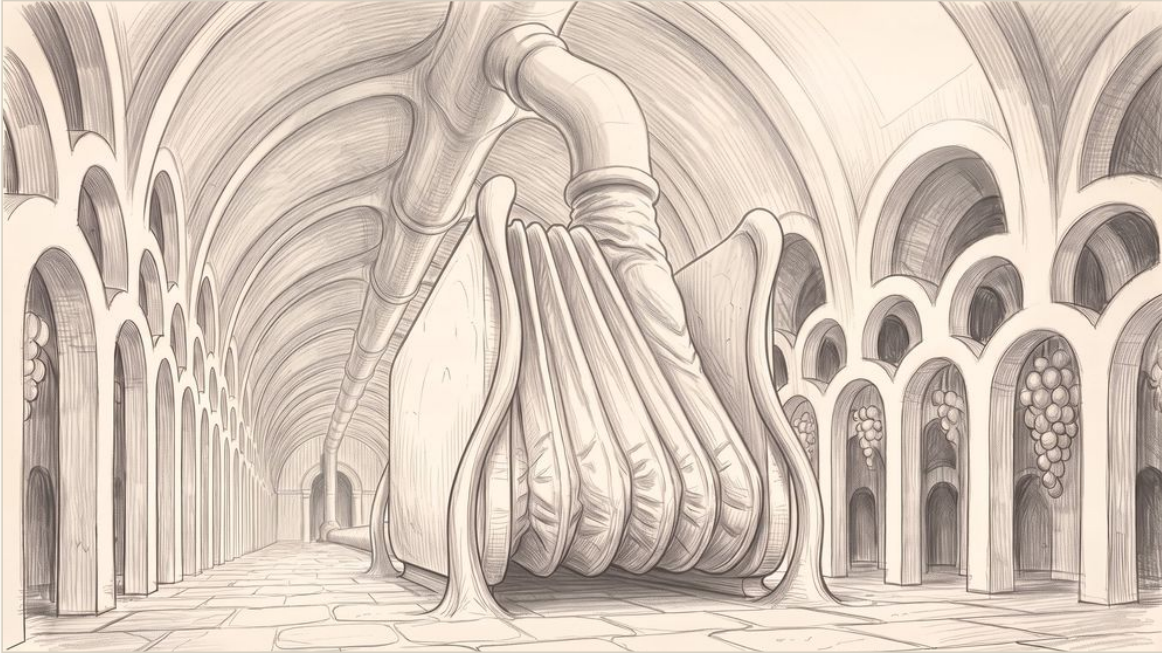
8-1-A-v3.png

WHAT IT IS

The hall as it was, with the heart door added at the vanishing point. Supersedes v2.

HOW IT MOVES

Same move, same speed as the muscle hall. Sameness is the point: three rooms that feel identical make the fourth door land. The bulbs breathe once, slowly, out of sync with each other.



PHASE 8.2

8-2-A-v3

8-2-A-v3.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 8.3

The muscle door

8-3-MUSCLE-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

A bundle of fibres raised in the clay, and the door standing a hand's width open because he has already tried it. Beyond the gap, soft darkness with nothing legible in it.

HOW IT MOVES

Push in on the gap. The door is already open a hand's width, so nothing opens on camera. We are looking at a decision somebody already made.



PHASE 8.4

The muscle hall, the lung door beyond

8-4-MUSCLE-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Tendon and cord running the length of the room, calm and slack rather than straining. This is the part of him that had been shouting all afternoon and it has nothing to say. The next door is visible at the far end of the same frame, because there is no cut anywhere after phase 5 and every transition is a passage through a surface.

HOW IT MOVES

Track forward down the hall at walking pace. The next door grows from a mark to a shape. Cross THROUGH it: the frame darkens as the door fills the lens and the next hall is already there. No cut.



PHASE 8.6

The heart hall, and the key door

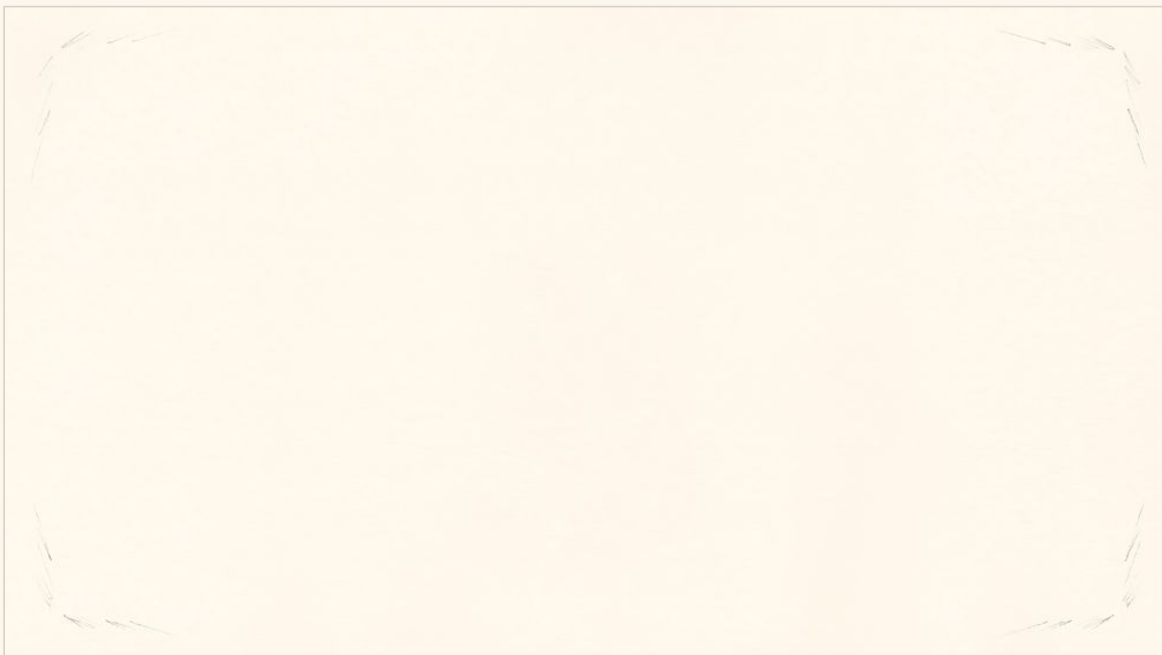
8-6-HEART-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

The last of the wrong rooms. Chambered and patient rather than urgent. At the vanishing point, a door carrying a key in clay: the first sight of the answer, at the smallest scale it will ever have.

HOW IT MOVES

Same move again, then SLOW as the key door resolves. This is the only place in the sequence the camera changes its mind, and it is the moment he realises.



PHASE 9.0

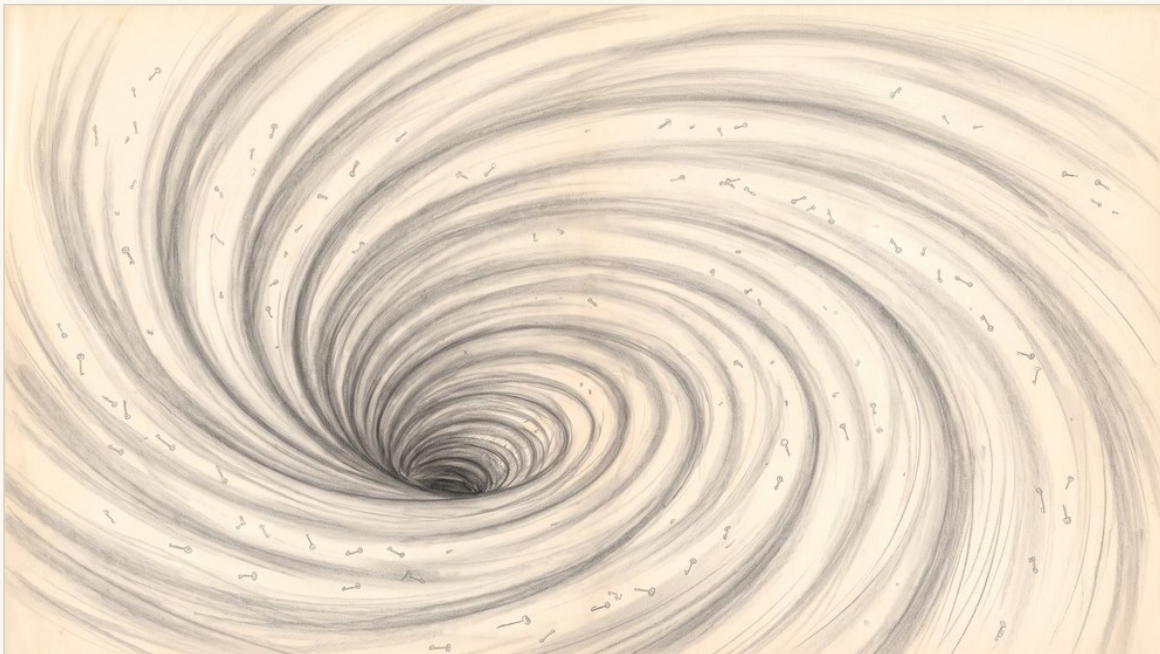
9-0-WHITE-v1

9-0-WHITE-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 9.2

The passage, at full presence

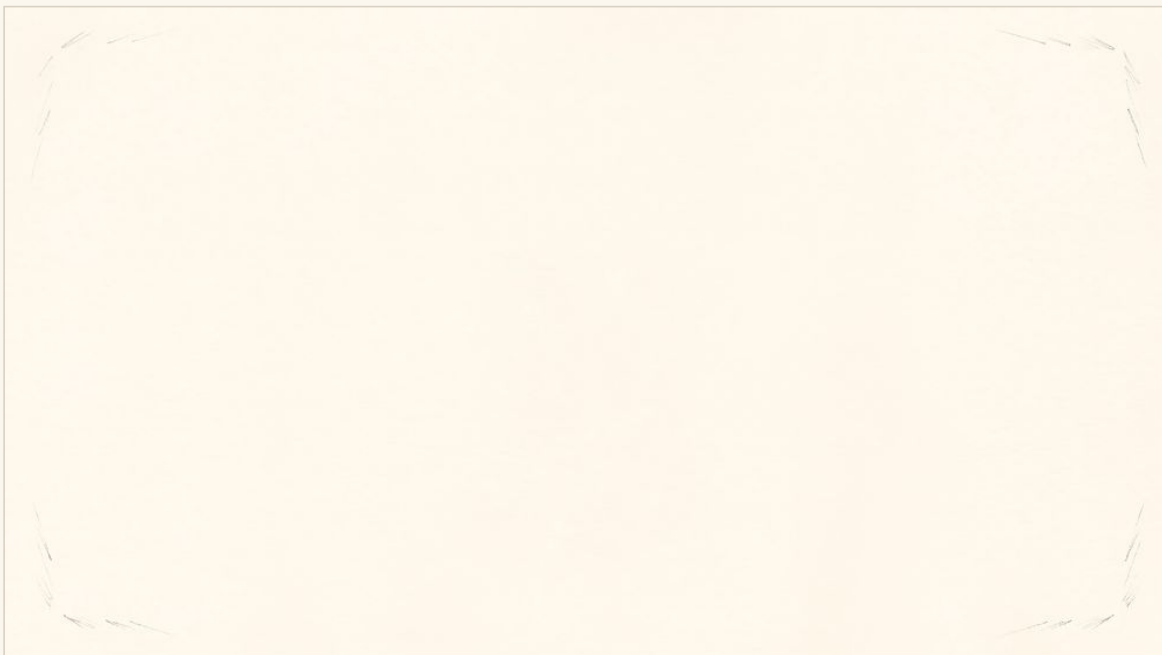
9-1-VORTEX-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

The vortex drawn as water, long soft strokes sweeping around and inward to an off centre throat, with the keys tiny and scattered and CARRIED by the current rather than building it. He is surrounded by thousands of the thing he is looking for and cannot see it, because he does not yet know he needs it. Replaces the Ganesha passage. Two earlier attempts built a wall out of keys and got a rosette.

HOW IT MOVES

The camera does not move. THE WATER DOES. The strands turn and climb and the throat holds its position, so the shot rotates without the frame rotating. Keys drift at their own speeds, never in step.



PHASE 9.3

9-3-WHITE-v1

9-3-WHITE-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 9.3

He begins to rise

9-2-MANAN-1-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

He is drawn upward, feet leaving whatever he was standing on. PHOTOGRAPHIC and monochrome inside a drawn world: he is real and the inside of the body is a drawing. His clothes and hair pull DOWNWARD because he is going up, which is the only thing that separates rising from falling.

HOW IT MOVES

He lifts out of the bottom of frame. Clothes and hair trail DOWNWARD, which is the only thing that tells the audience he is rising and not falling. Get that wrong and the whole passage reads backwards.



PHASE 9.4

The turn

9-2-MANAN-2-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

The current rolls him onto his side as it lifts him and he looks back down the way he came. Calm rather than frightened. The strands of keys are the water itself, sparse and dotted, and he is passing through thousands of the thing he is looking for without seeing one of them.

HOW IT MOVES

He rotates as he rises, carried rather than swimming. He never once looks at the keys. That is the shot: he is inside the answer and cannot see it.



PHASE 9.5

He rises past us

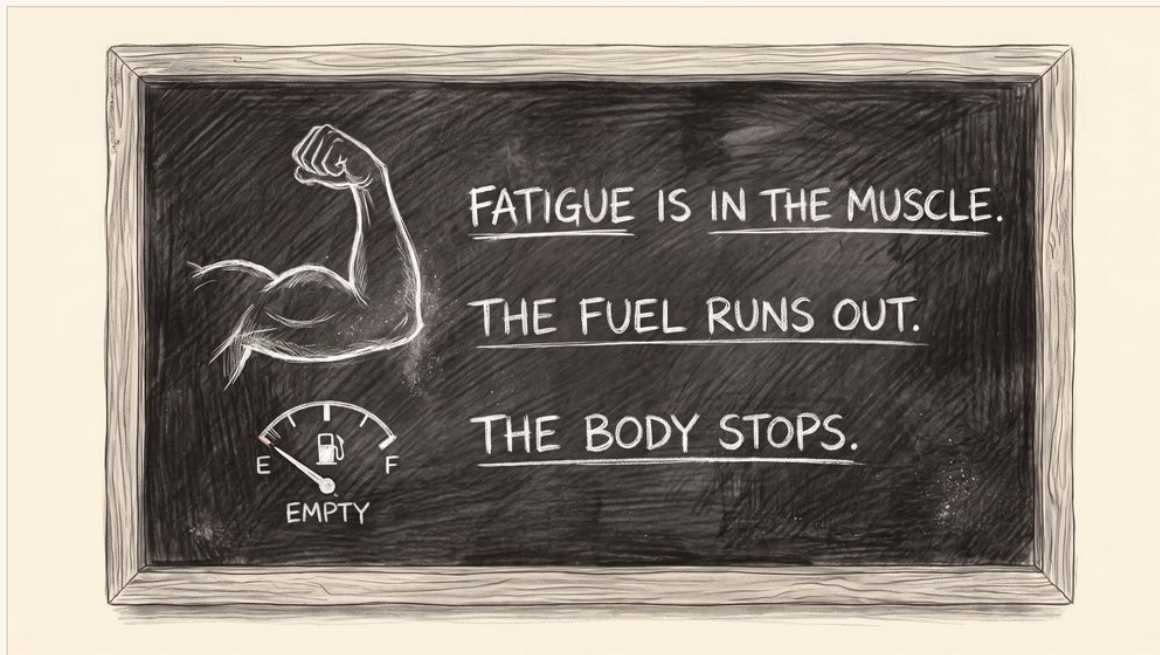
9-2-MANAN-3-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Close to the throat, face open, astonishment with no fear in it. The last frame before he arrives standing in the house, so it is the one clear look the audience gets at him inside the drawn world.

HOW IT MOVES

He passes the lens and leaves the top of frame. Do not cut. The paper he leaves behind becomes the white of the house, so the next shot is already underway before this one ends.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-A-v2

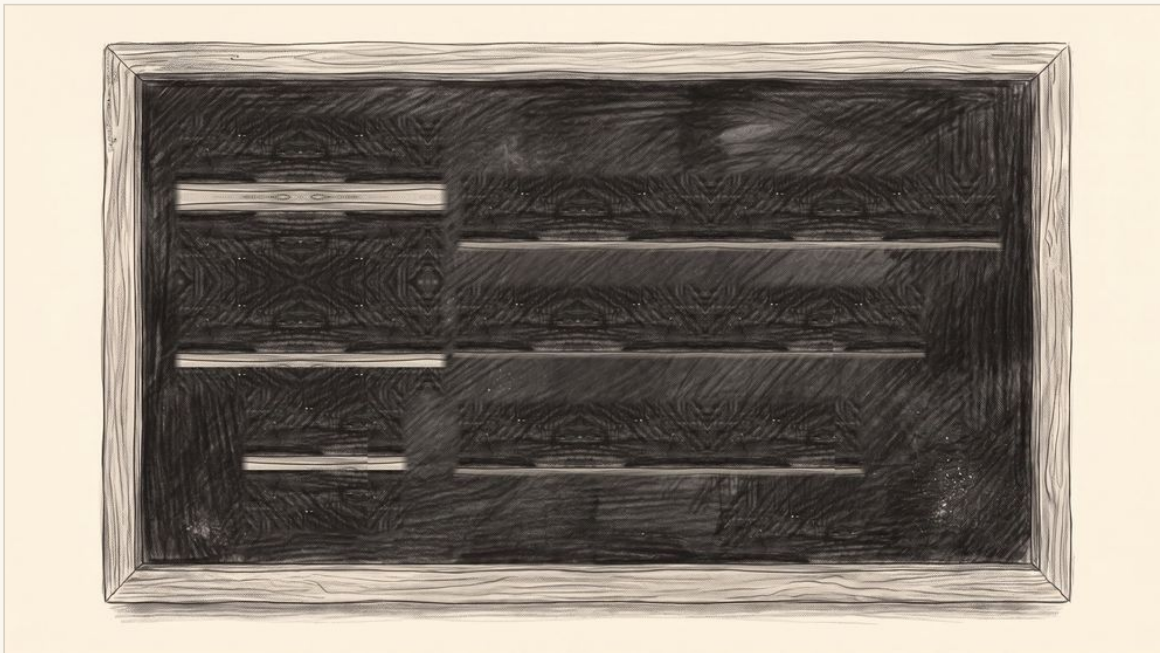
10-0-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

THE OLD THEORY. Manan's board, and only his. The arm, the fuel gauge at EMPTY, and three lines each underlined: FATIGUE IS IN THE MUSCLE, THE FUEL RUNS OUT, THE BODY STOPS. This is the 1923 answer he arrives with, having read it in a book. BLACKBOARD AND WHITE CHALK ON PURPOSE: Coach Brain answers on a whiteboard in black marker, and the reversal of surface and mark is what the audience feels before they follow the argument. The chalk draws itself as he speaks, RSA Animate style, so the board is never revealed finished. THIS IS THE FINISHED BOARD. An attempt to fill the lower right with a collapsed runner was rejected, so the empty stretch stays empty and the chalk simply stops there.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-BUILD-0

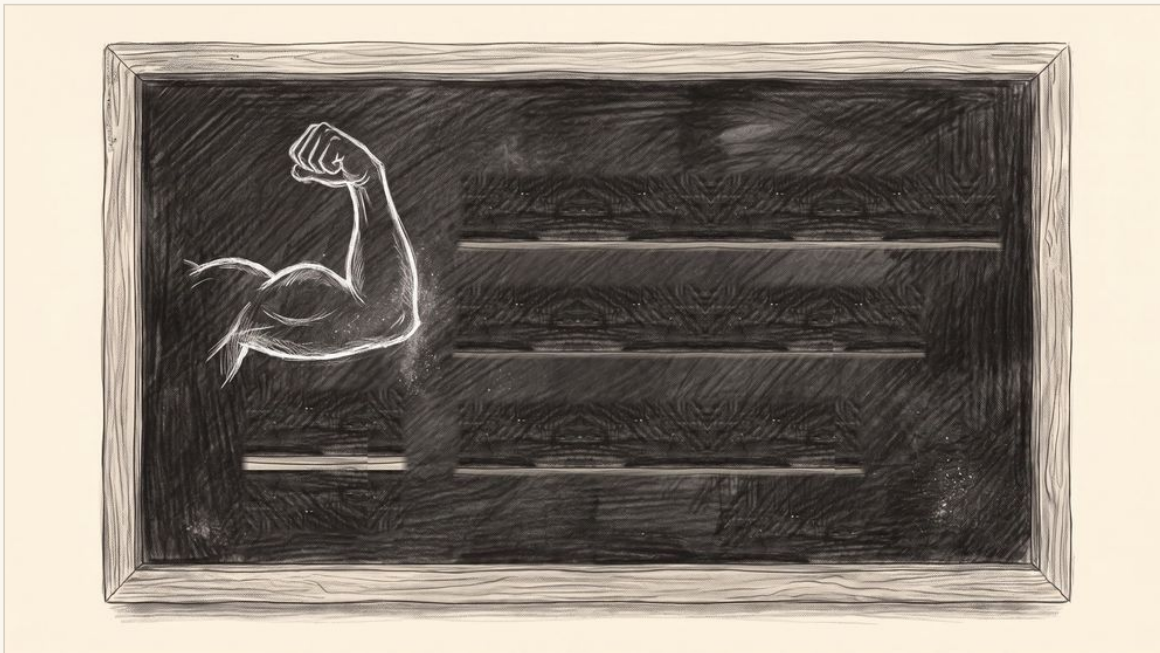
10-0-BUILD-0.png

WHAT IT IS

BOARD BUILD STATE 0 of 5. Shows: bare board. These are for the animatic: cut from one to the next in time with the voice so the chalk appears as Manan says the words. SUBTRACTED from the finished board rather than generated, so every state registers to the pixel. There are faint horizontal ghosts on the bare states where the chalk was; they do not read in motion at 5 to 7 frames a second and were left rather than chased.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-BUILD-1

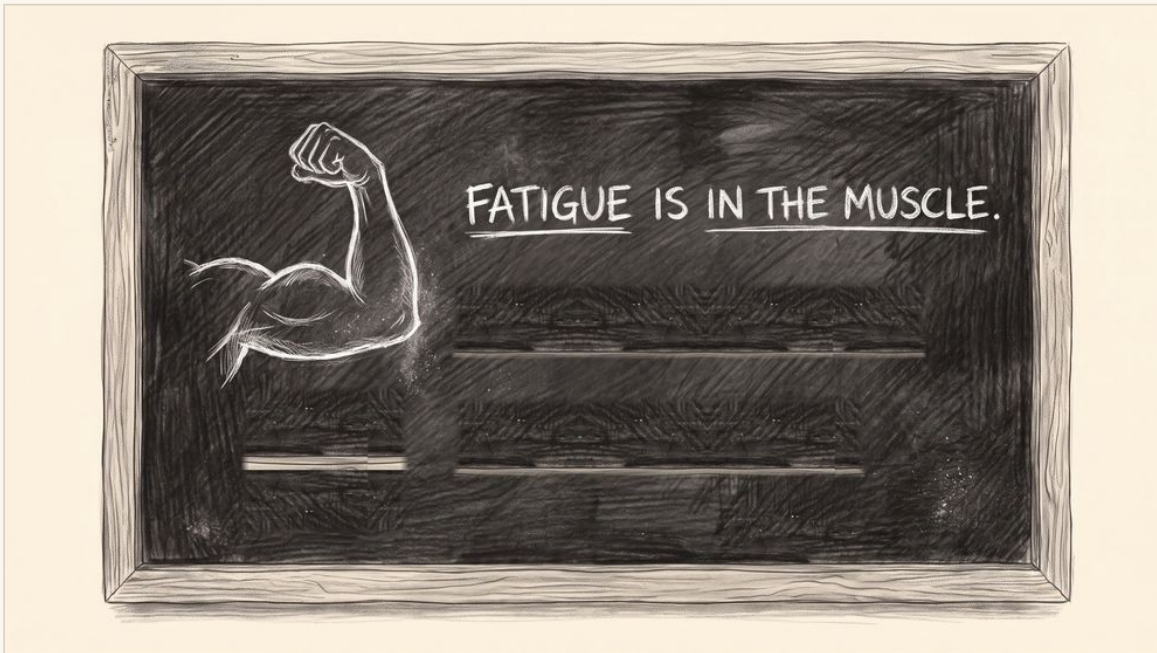
10-0-BUILD-1.png

WHAT IT IS

BOARD BUILD STATE 1 of 5. Shows: the arm. These are for the animatic: cut from one to the next in time with the voice so the chalk appears as Manan says the words. SUBTRACTED from the finished board rather than generated, so every state registers to the pixel. There are faint horizontal ghosts on the bare states where the chalk was; they do not read in motion at 5 to 7 frames a second and were left rather than chased.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-BUILD-2

10-0-BUILD-2.png

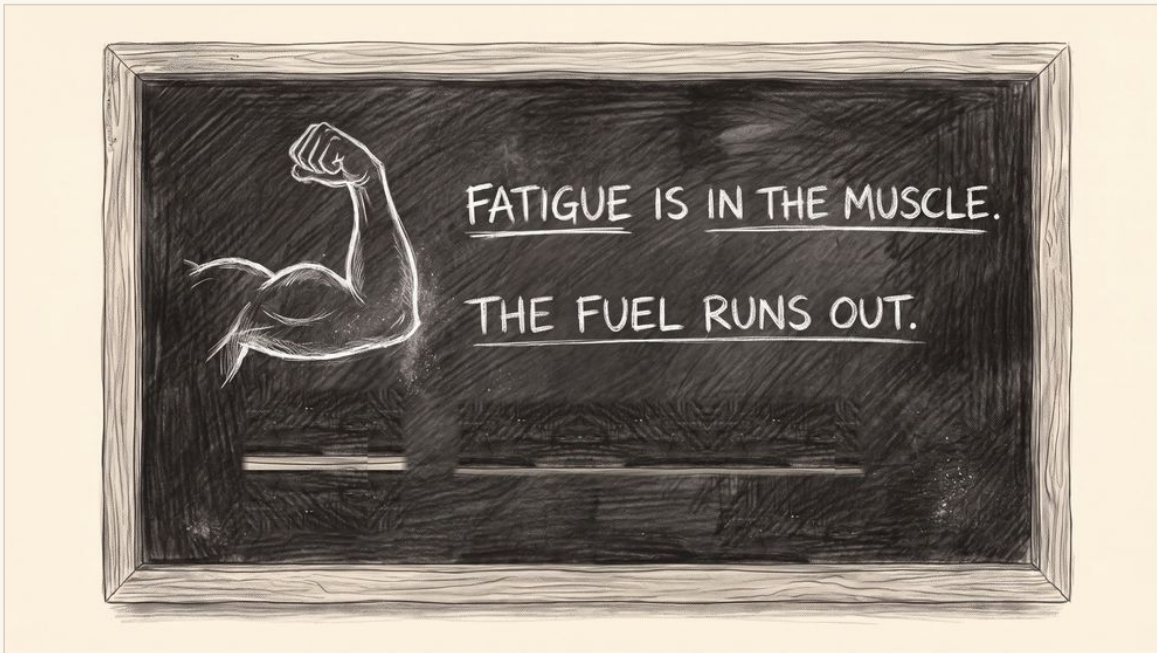
WHAT IT IS

BOARD BUILD STATE 2 of 5. Shows: + FATIGUE IS IN THE MUSCLE. These are for the animatic: cut from one to the next in time with the voice so the chalk appears as Manan says the words. SUBTRACTED from the finished board rather than generated, so every state registers to the pixel.

There are faint horizontal ghosts on the bare states where the chalk was; they do not read in motion at 5 to 7 frames a second and were left rather than chased.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-BUILD-3

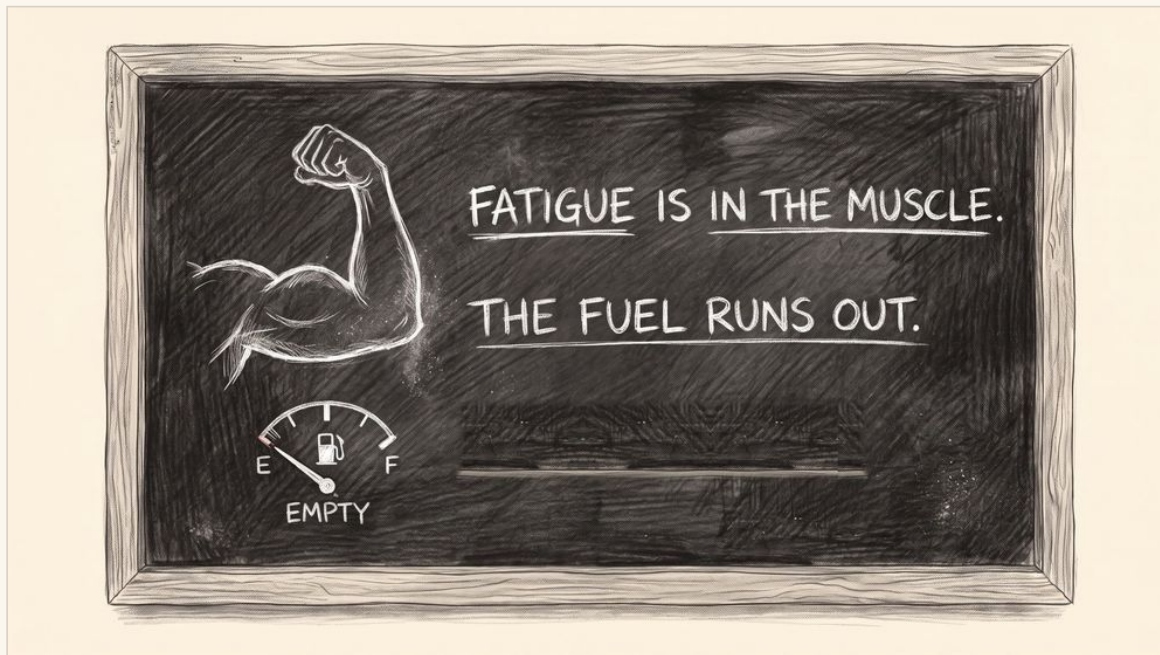
10-0-BUILD-3.png

WHAT IT IS

BOARD BUILD STATE 3 of 5. Shows: + THE FUEL RUNS OUT. These are for the animatic: cut from one to the next in time with the voice so the chalk appears as Manan says the words. SUBTRACTED from the finished board rather than generated, so every state registers to the pixel. There are faint horizontal ghosts on the bare states where the chalk was; they do not read in motion at 5 to 7 frames a second and were left rather than chased.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-BUILD-4

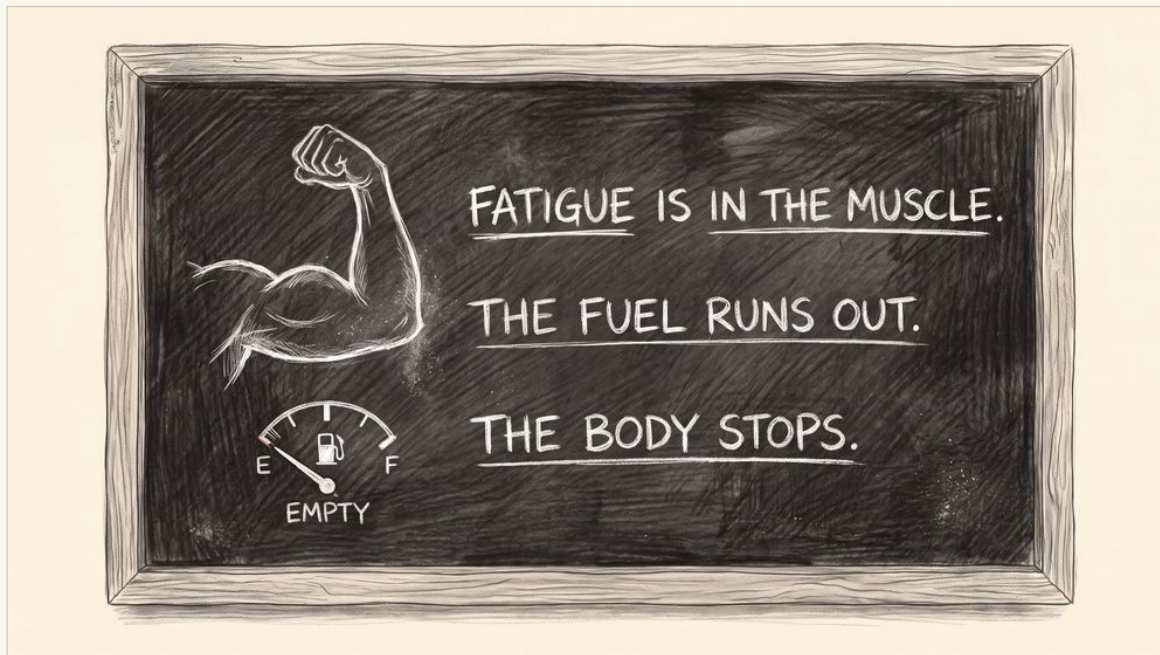
10-0-BUILD-4.png

WHAT IT IS

BOARD BUILD STATE 4 of 5. Shows: + the gauge at EMPTY. These are for the animatic: cut from one to the next in time with the voice so the chalk appears as Manan says the words. SUBTRACTED from the finished board rather than generated, so every state registers to the pixel. There are faint horizontal ghosts on the bare states where the chalk was; they do not read in motion at 5 to 7 frames a second and were left rather than chased.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.0

10-0-BUILD-5

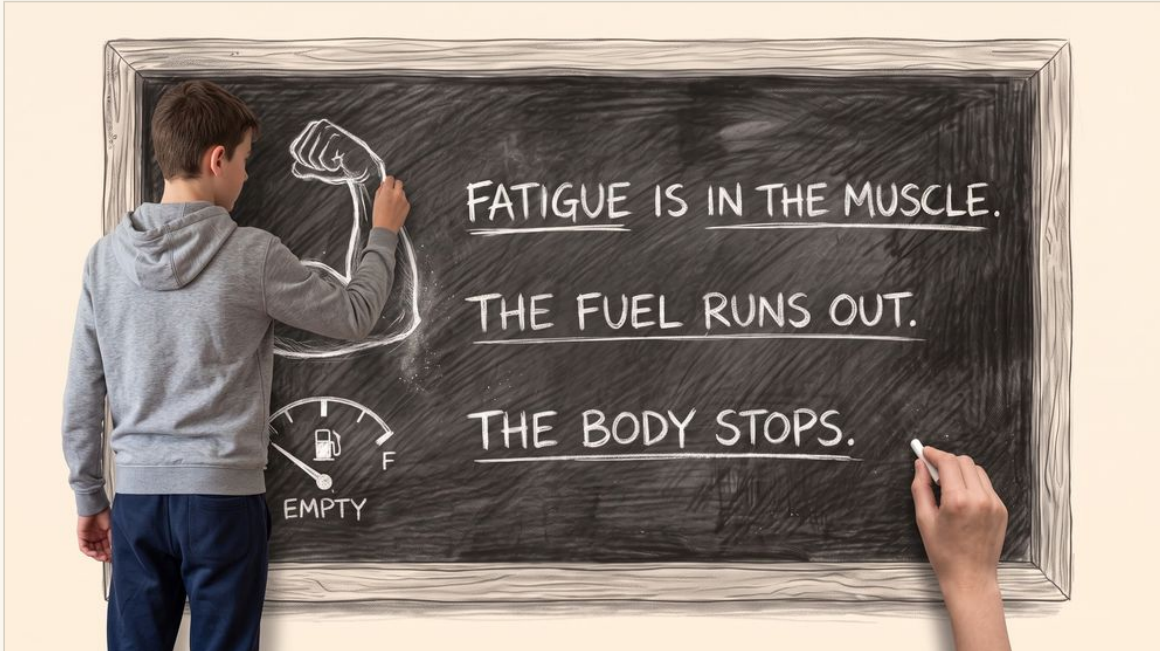
10-0-BUILD-5.png

WHAT IT IS

BOARD BUILD STATE 5 of 5. Shows: + THE BODY STOPS. These are for the animatic: cut from one to the next in time with the voice so the chalk appears as Manan says the words. SUBTRACTED from the finished board rather than generated, so every state registers to the pixel. There are faint horizontal ghosts on the bare states where the chalk was; they do not read in motion at 5 to 7 frames a second and were left rather than chased.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 10.1

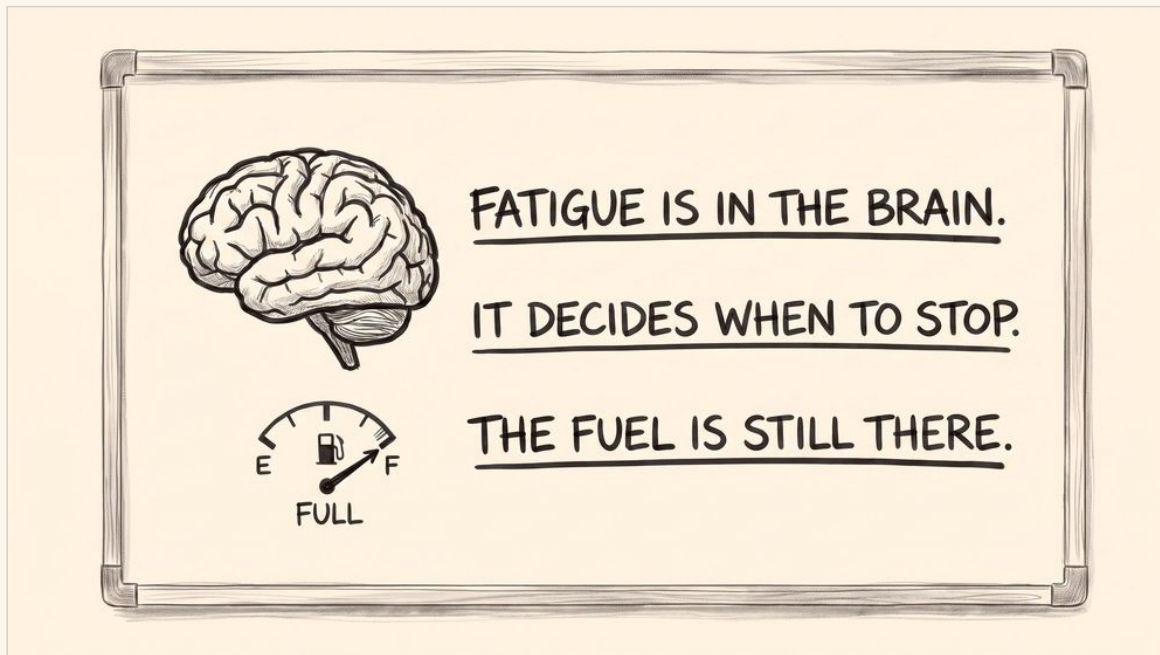
10-1-MOCKUP-v1

10-1-MOCKUP-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-A-v1

11-0-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

THE NEW THEORY. Coach Brain's answer, and THE INVERSION IS THE POINT: same layout, same three lines, same gauge as shot 10, with every value reversed. Blackboard and white chalk becomes whiteboard and black marker. Measured, mean luminance 135 against 226. THE GAUGE CARRIES THE ARGUMENT: the same instrument in both frames with the needle moved from EMPTY to FULL says the fuel was always there without a word being spoken. Cut one to the other and the audience understands before they have read the sentences. The lower right is left empty in both, because the marker is still going while he talks.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-BUILD-0

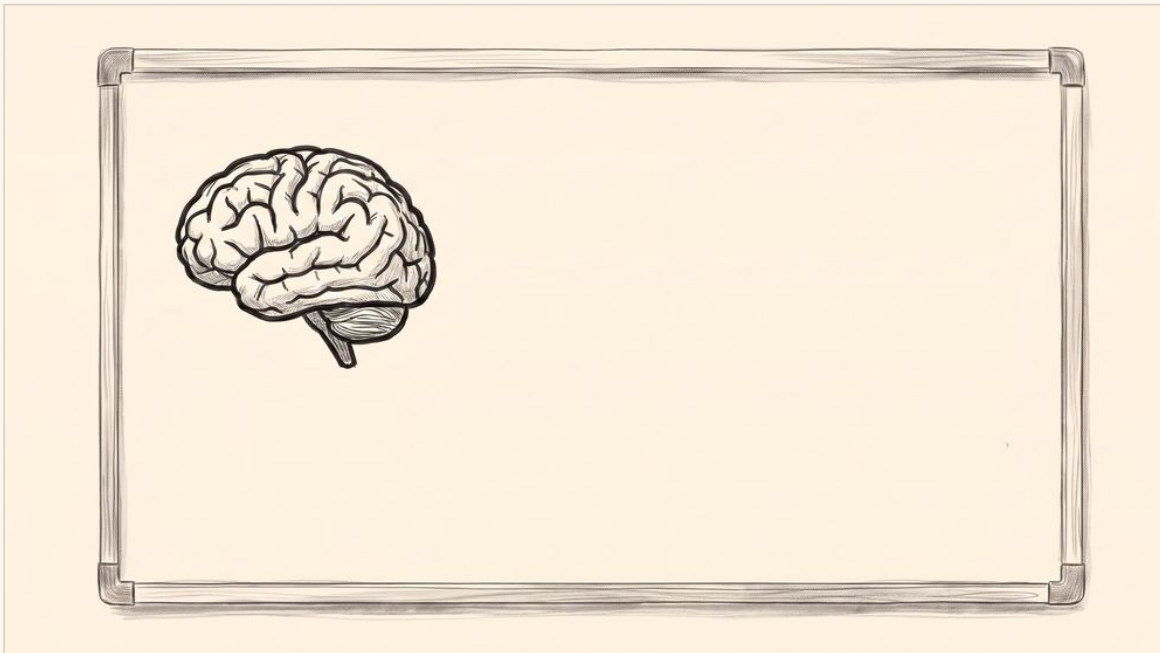
11-0-BUILD-0.png

WHAT IT IS

WHITEBOARD BUILD STATE 0 of 5. Shows: bare whiteboard. Cut from one to the next in time with Coach Brain speaking, so the marker appears as he says the words. Subtracted from the finished board so every state registers to the pixel, and the whiteboard erases perfectly clean because the surface is plain.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-BUILD-1

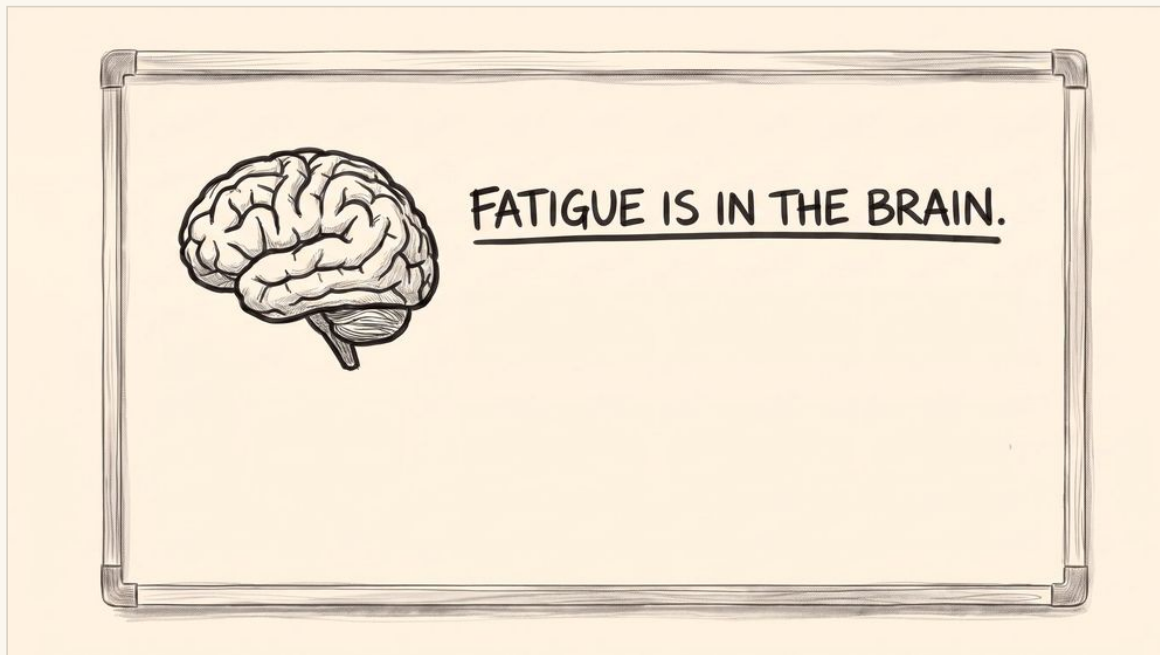
11-0-BUILD-1.png

WHAT IT IS

WHITEBOARD BUILD STATE 1 of 5. Shows: the brain. Cut from one to the next in time with Coach Brain speaking, so the marker appears as he says the words. Subtracted from the finished board so every state registers to the pixel, and the whiteboard erases perfectly clean because the surface is plain.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-BUILD-2

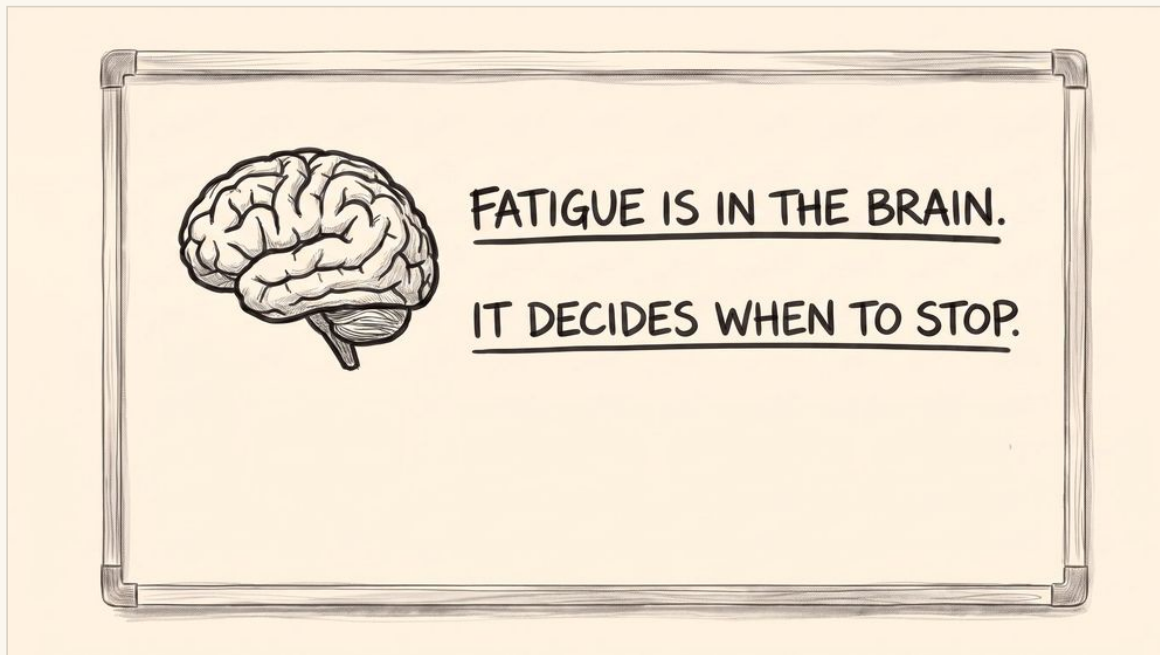
11-0-BUILD-2.png

WHAT IT IS

WHITEBOARD BUILD STATE 2 of 5. Shows: + FATIGUE IS IN THE BRAIN. Cut from one to the next in time with Coach Brain speaking, so the marker appears as he says the words. Subtracted from the finished board so every state registers to the pixel, and the whiteboard erases perfectly clean because the surface is plain.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-BUILD-3

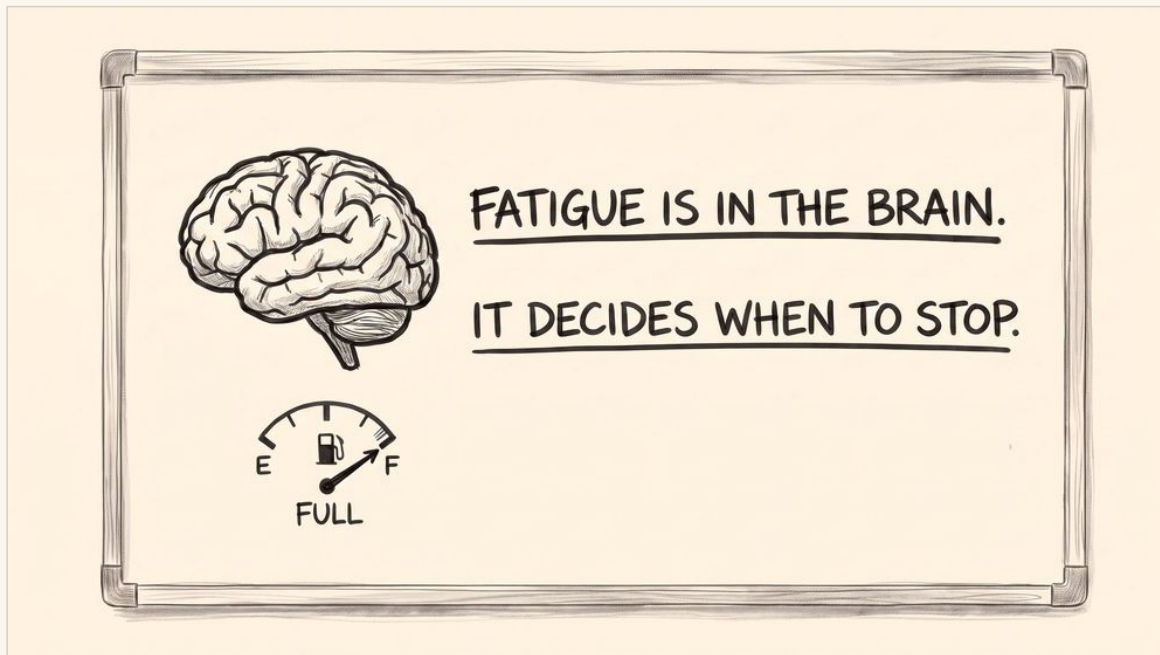
11-0-BUILD-3.png

WHAT IT IS

WHITEBOARD BUILD STATE 3 of 5. Shows: + IT DECIDES WHEN TO STOP. Cut from one to the next in time with Coach Brain speaking, so the marker appears as he says the words. Subtracted from the finished board so every state registers to the pixel, and the whiteboard erases perfectly clean because the surface is plain.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-BUILD-4

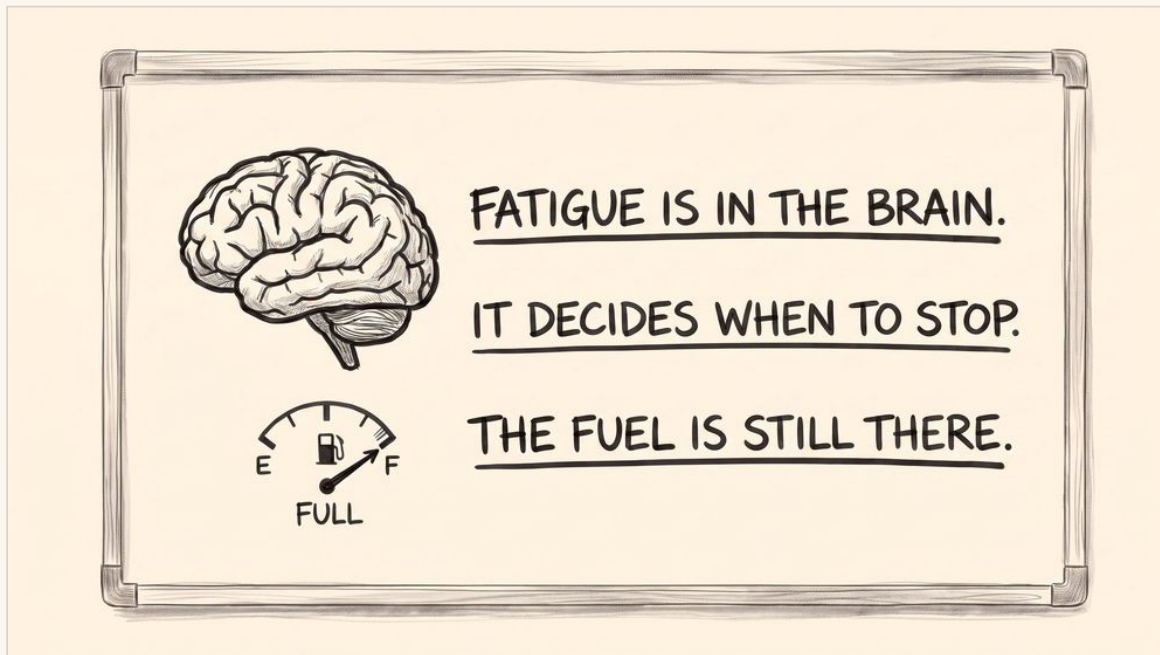
11-0-BUILD-4.png

WHAT IT IS

WHITEBOARD BUILD STATE 4 of 5. Shows: + the gauge at FULL. Cut from one to the next in time with Coach Brain speaking, so the marker appears as he says the words. Subtracted from the finished board so every state registers to the pixel, and the whiteboard erases perfectly clean because the surface is plain.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 11.0

11-0-BUILD-5

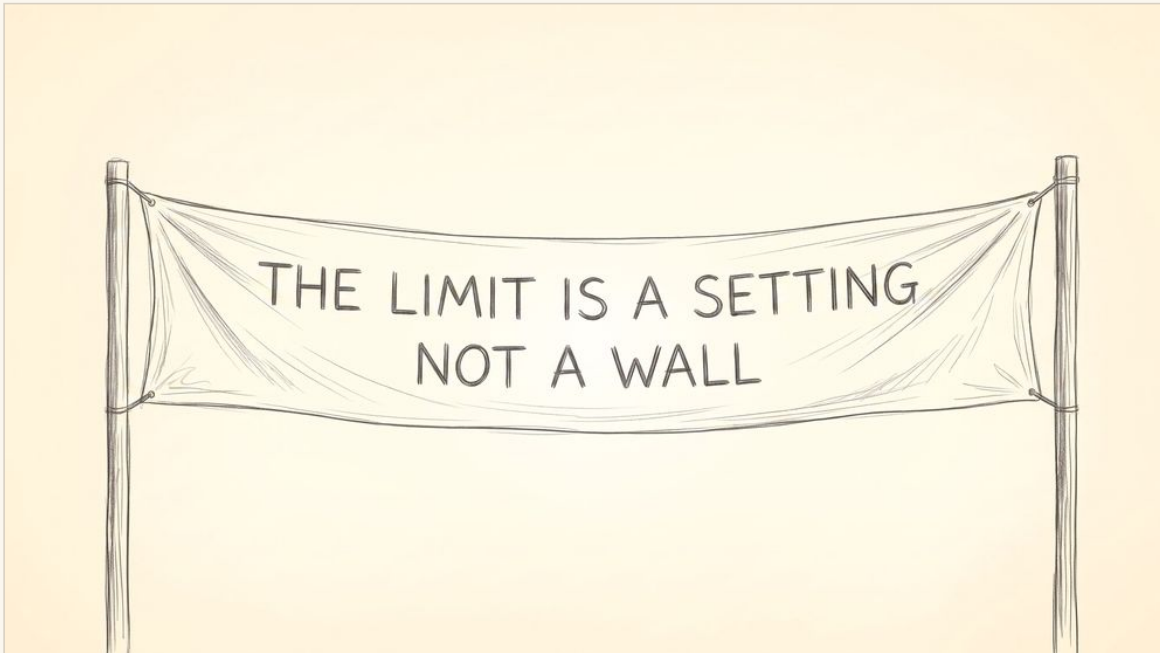
11-0-BUILD-5.png

WHAT IT IS

WHITEBOARD BUILD STATE 5 of 5. Shows: + THE FUEL IS STILL THERE. Cut from one to the next in time with Coach Brain speaking, so the marker appears as he says the words. Subtracted from the finished board so every state registers to the pixel, and the whiteboard erases perfectly clean because the surface is plain.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 12.0

12-0-A-v1

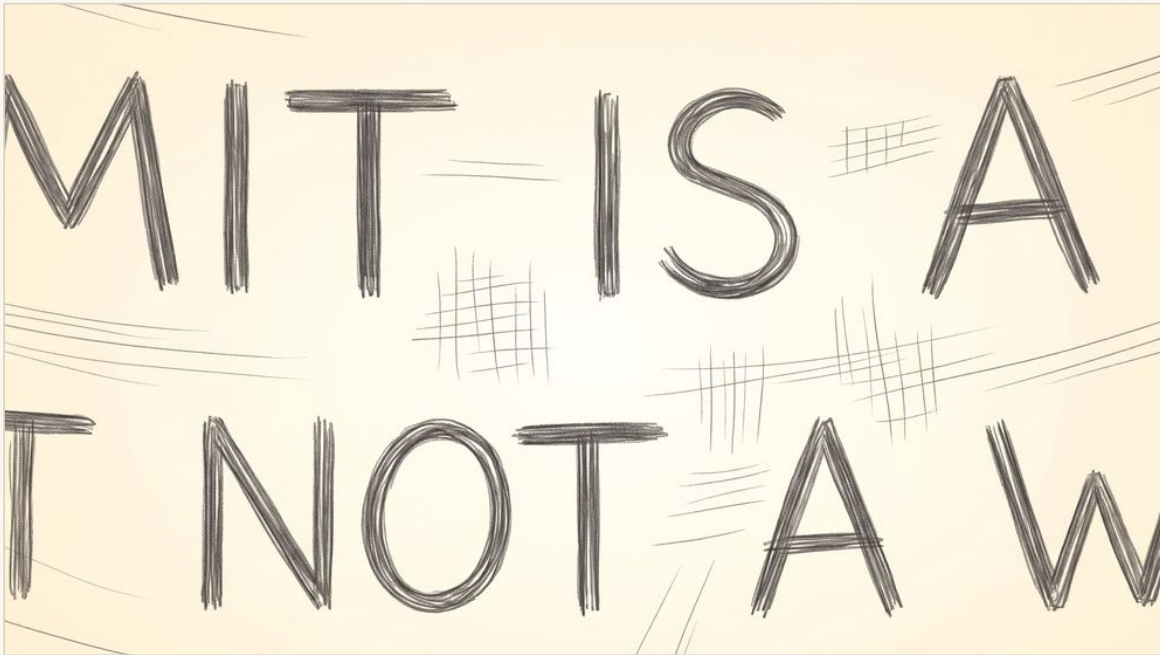
12-0-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

THE ENDCARD, and the film's closing rhyme. The finish banner from shot 1.2b, which was tiny between the trees and unreadable, is now the whole frame with the sentence on it: THE LIMIT IS A SETTING, NOT A WALL. The object that opened the film closes it. 4 percent ink, everything else bare paper.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 12.1

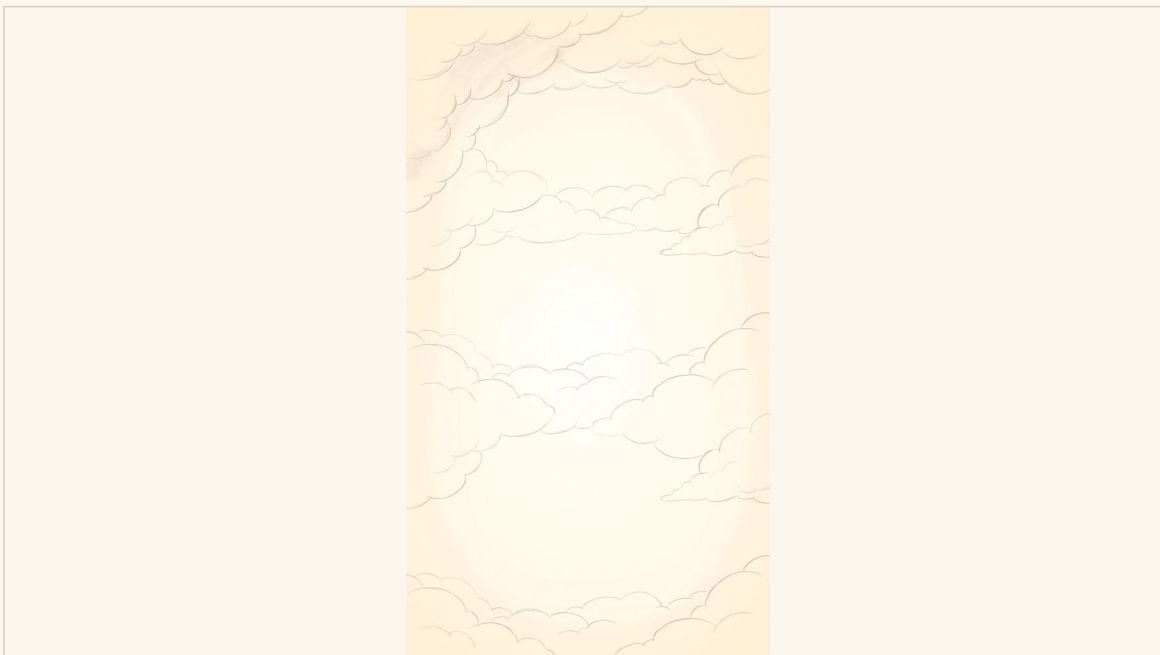
12-1-A-v3

12-1-A-v3.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.0

14-0-CLOUD-PLATE-v1

14-0-CLOUD-PLATE-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.1

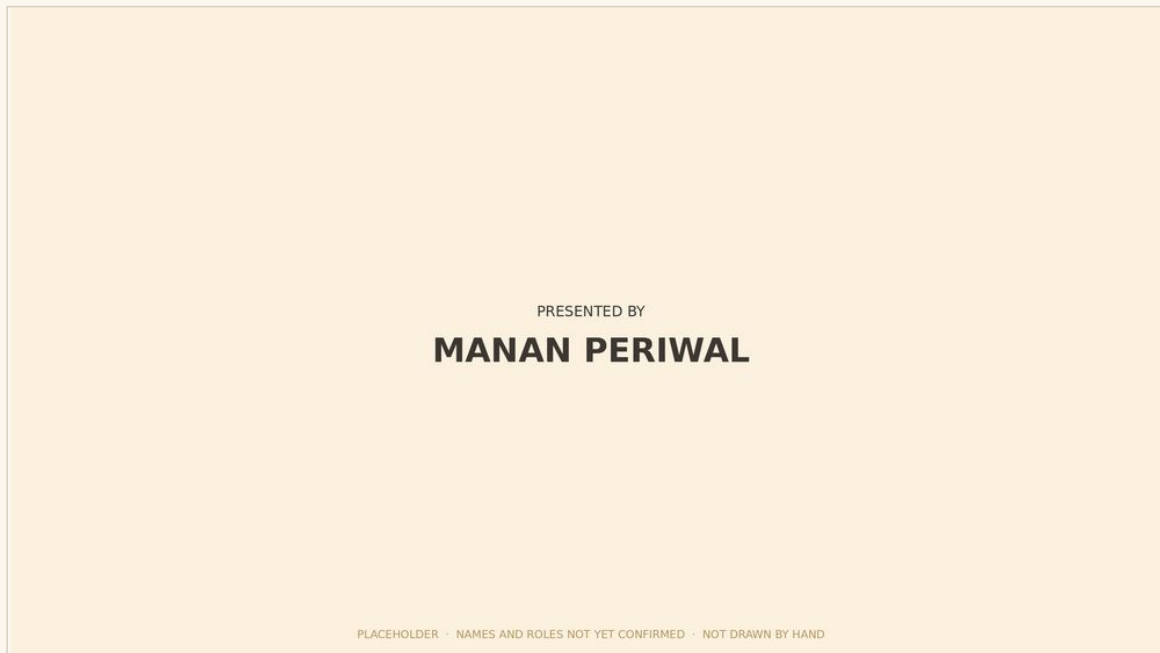
14-1-CREDITS-v2

14-1-CREDITS-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.2

14-2-CREDITS-v1

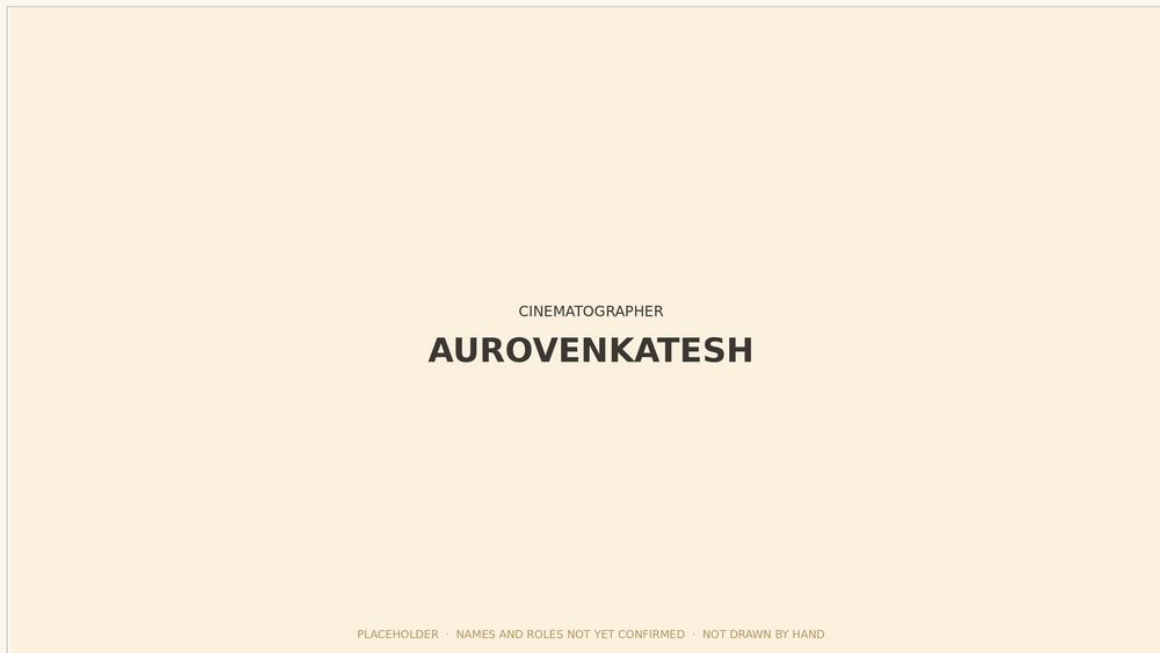
14-2-CREDITS-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Placeholder credit card.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.3

14-3-CREDITS-v1

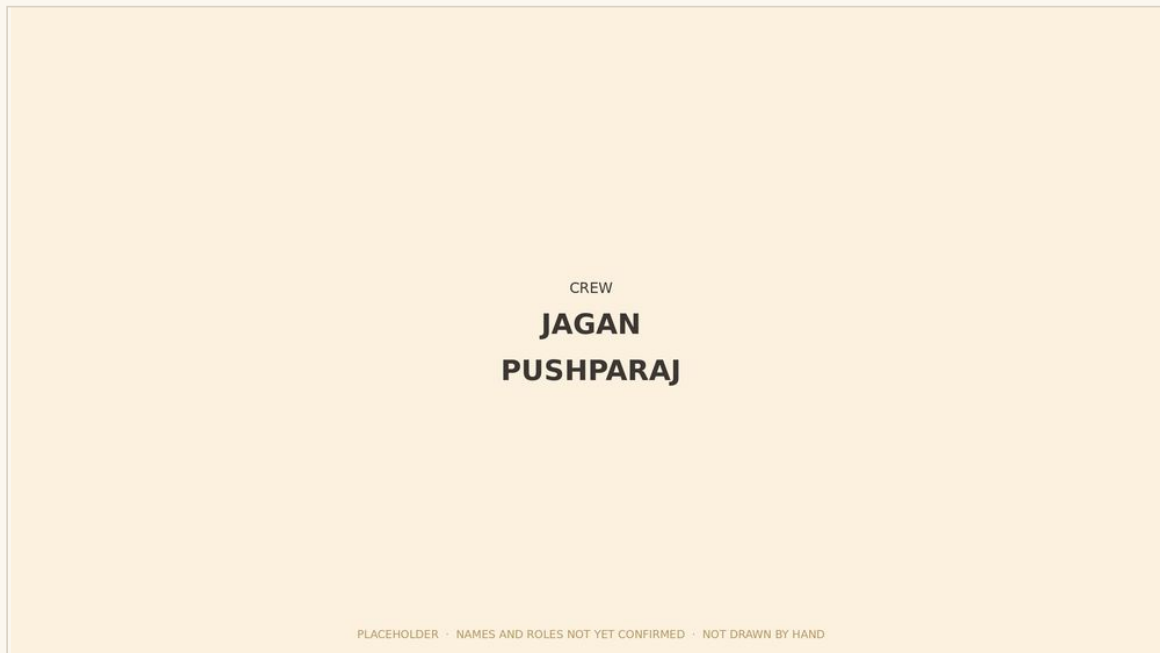
14-3-CREDITS-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Placeholder credit card.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.4

14-4-CREDITS-v1

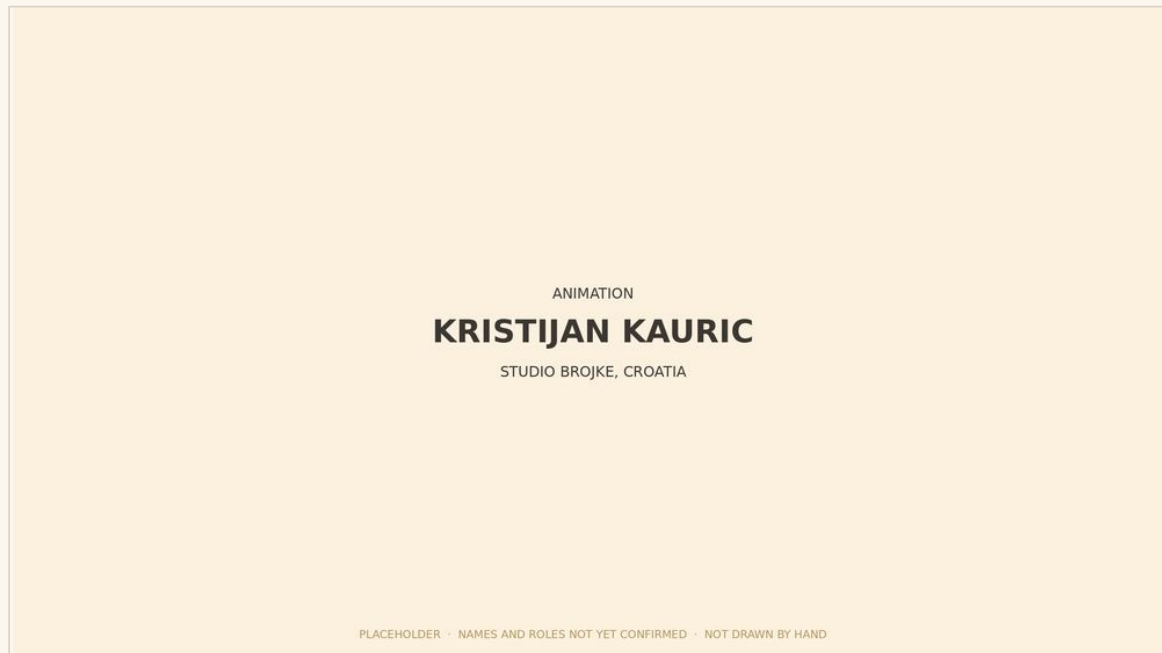
14-4-CREDITS-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Placeholder credit card.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.5

14-5-CREDITS-v1

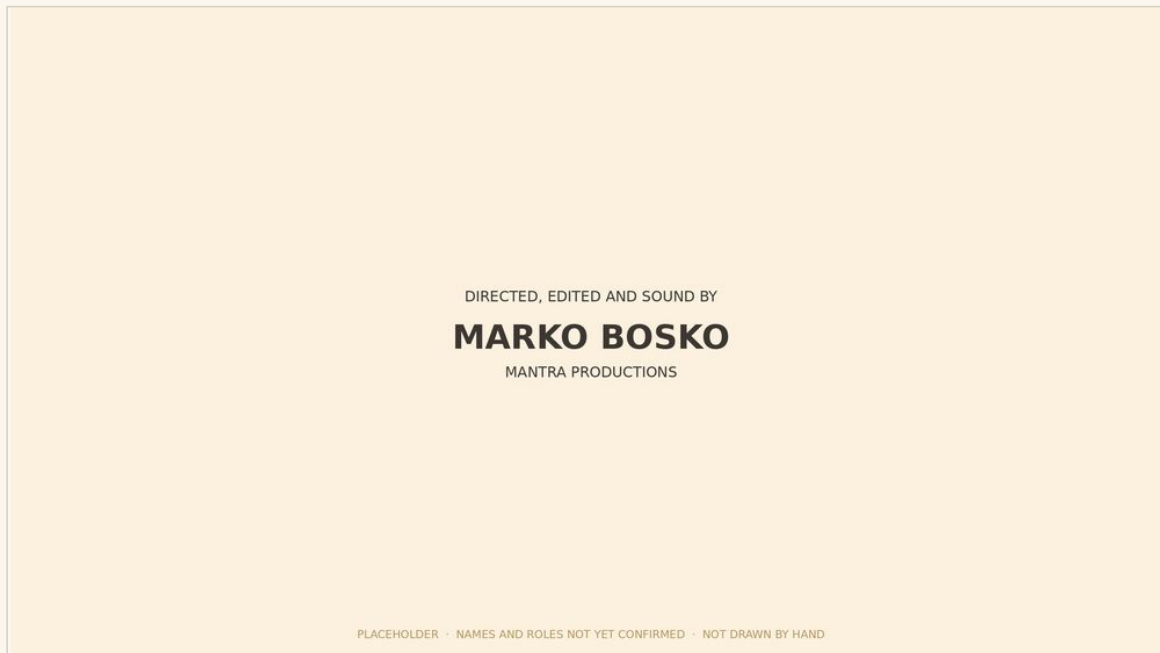
14-5-CREDITS-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Placeholder credit card.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.6

14-6-CREDITS-v1

14-6-CREDITS-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Placeholder credit card.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 14.7

14-7-CREDITS-v1

14-7-CREDITS-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Placeholder credit card.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



DEDICATED TO LORD GANESHA
REMOVER OF OBSTACLES

PHASE 14.8

Dedicated to Lord Ganesha

14-8-DEDICATION-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

The last card of the film. The film is an offering, made and then given away, the way food is offered before it is eaten. Nothing before this hints at it, which is the difference between a theme and a gift. The lettering is drawn by the same hand that drew the figure: v1 came back as a typeface because the reference order put a frame with no lettering in it first.

HOW IT MOVES

The last card. Ganesha rubs on by frottage, the lettering after him, then hold in silence with the music. Nothing moves out. The film simply stops.



PHASE 15.1

15-1-A-v1

15-1-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Off the strip 1.9.2026. Carries the old modern key, not the real object, and the wrist has no tracksuit cuff. The release now starts on the turn.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.2

15-2-A-v3

15-2-A-v3.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.5

PANA6276_11_47_46_08

PANA6276_11_47_46_08.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.6

PANA6279_11_48_30_06

PANA6279_11_48_30_06.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.7

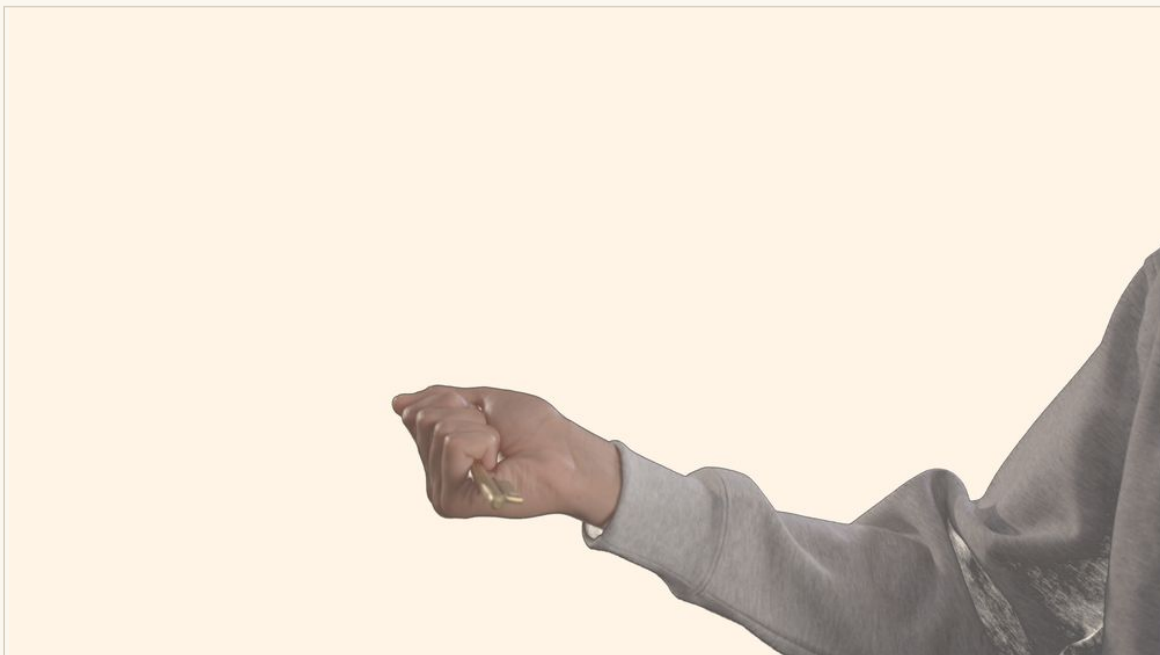
PANA6270_11_46_40_11

PANA6270_11_46_40_11.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.8

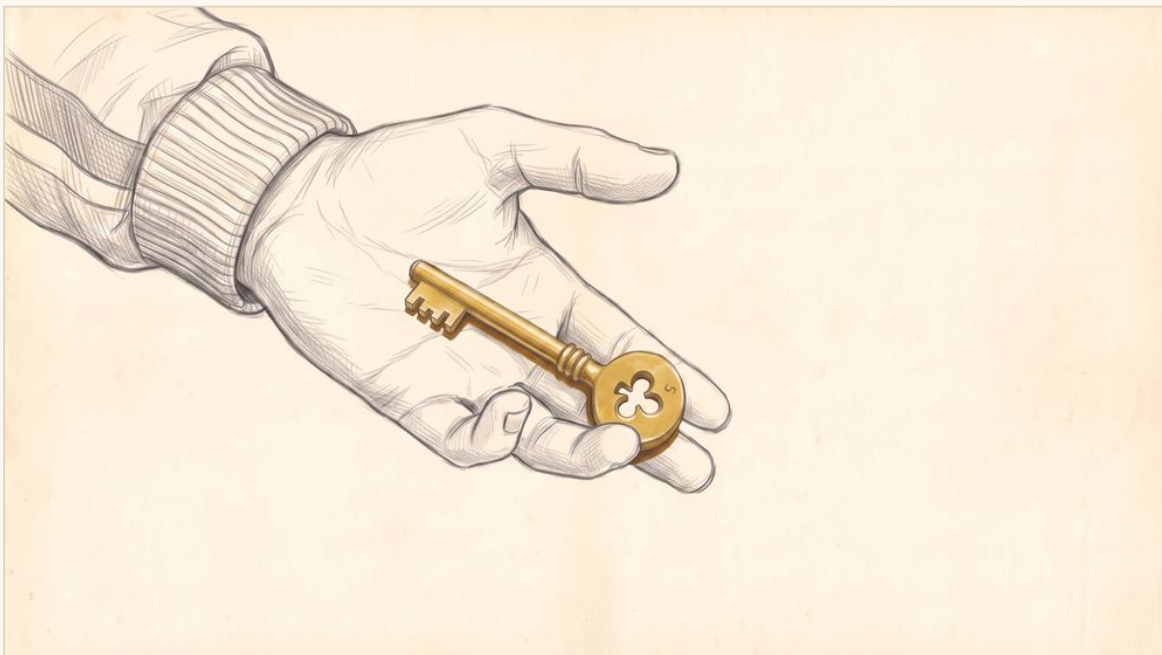
KEY_CATCH_1_00_00_04_19

KEY_CATCH_1_00_00_04_19.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.15

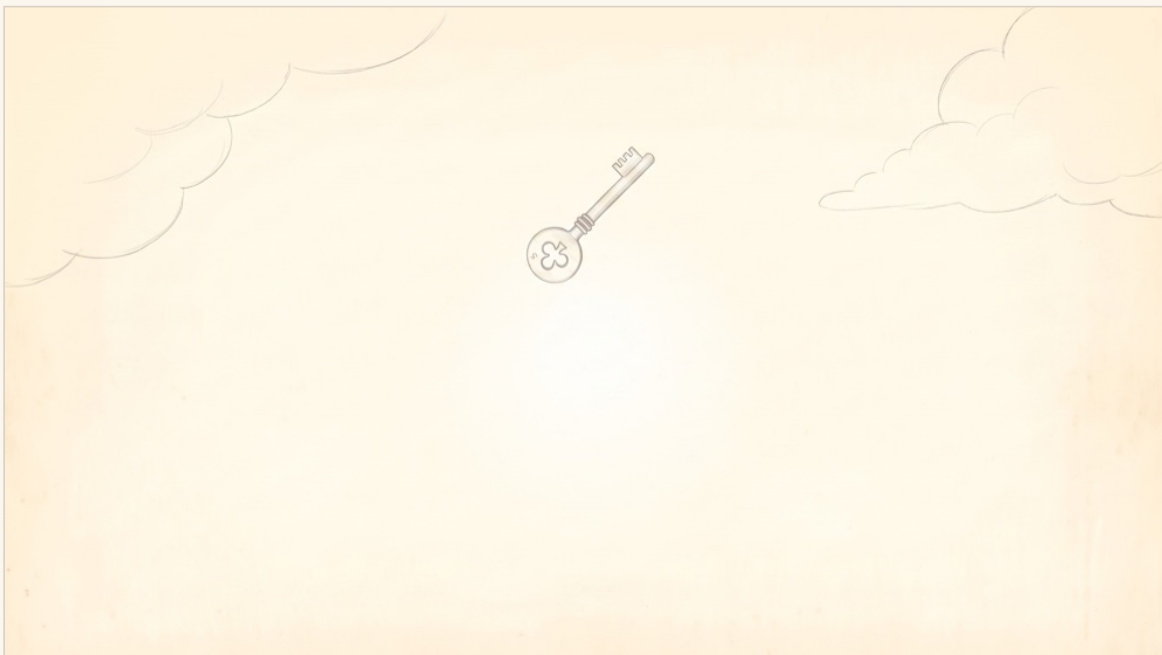
15-1-B-v2

15-1-B-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.31

15-3-FALL-1-v1

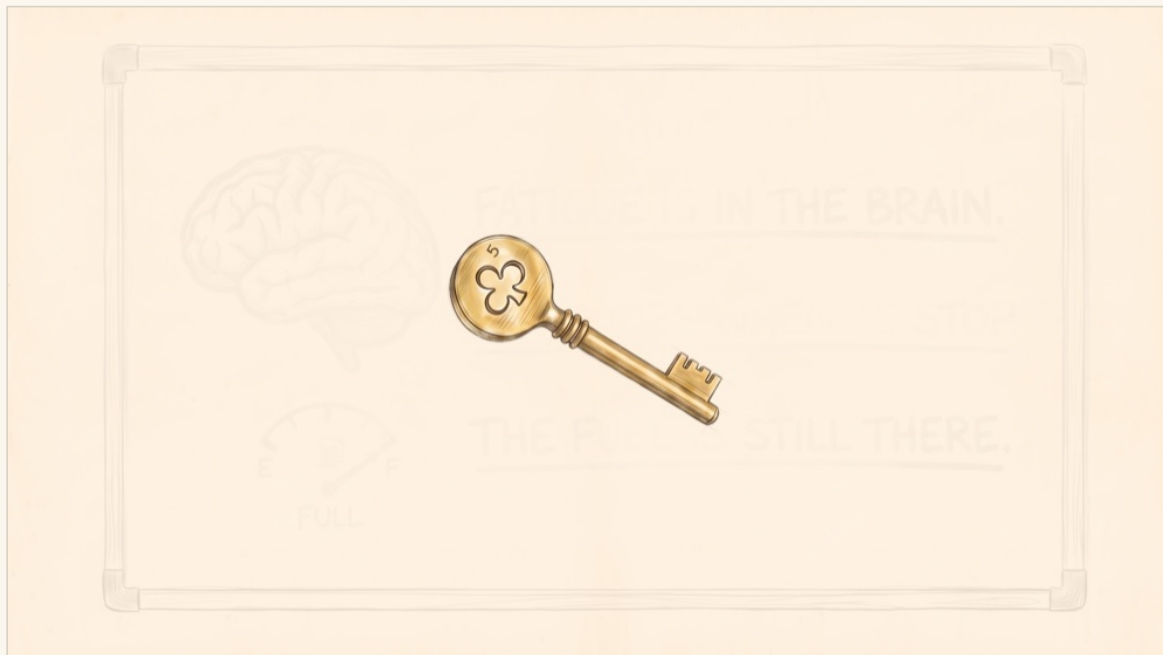
15-3-FALL-1-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

Off the strip 1.9.2026: measured 0.00 percent colour, so the key was never made gold. v2 was generated to fix it and never reached the repository.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.33

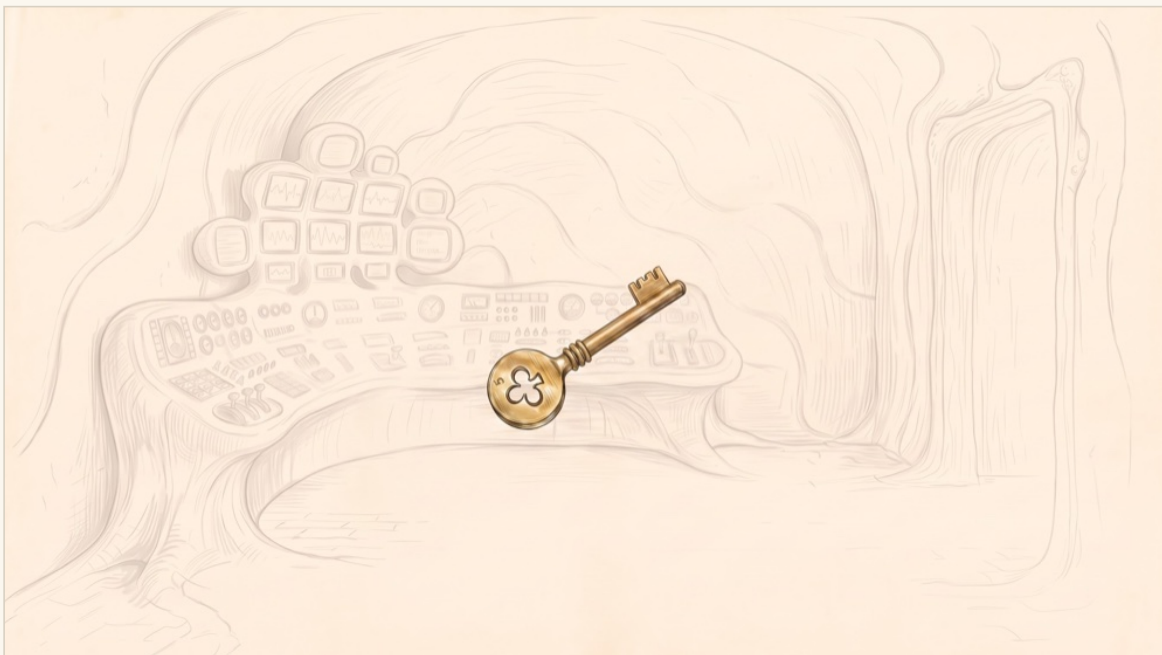
15-3-FALL-3-v4

15-3-FALL-3-v4.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.34

15-3-FALL-4-v2

15-3-FALL-4-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 15.35

15-3-FALL-5-v1

15-3-FALL-5-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 16.0

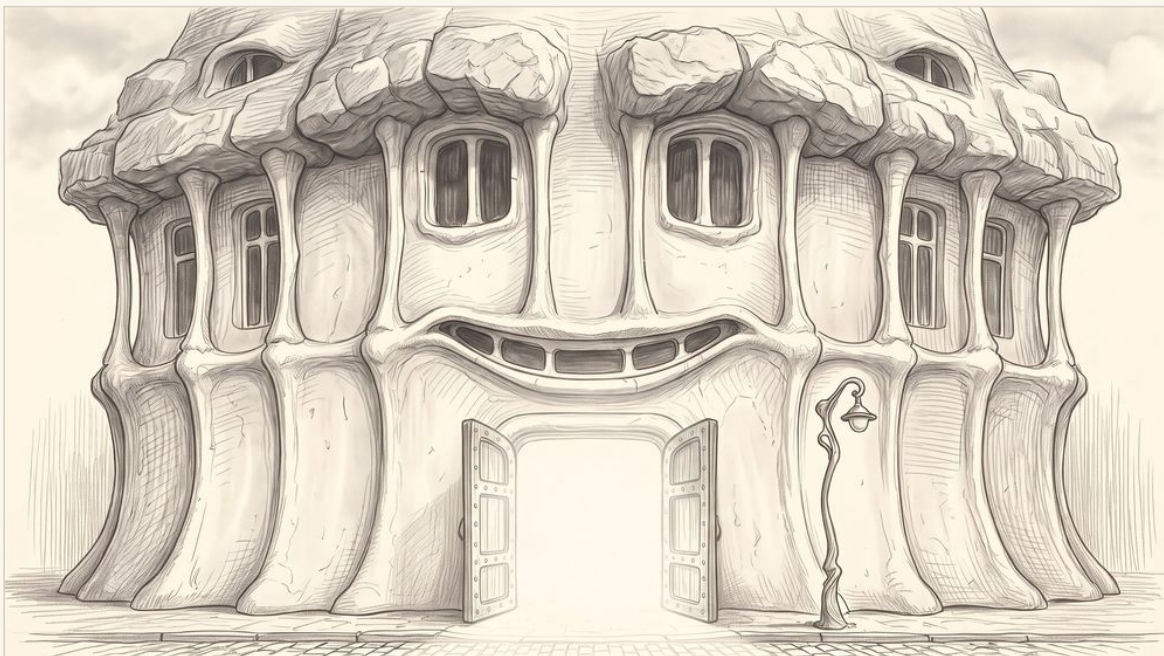
16-0-A-v1

16-0-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 16.1

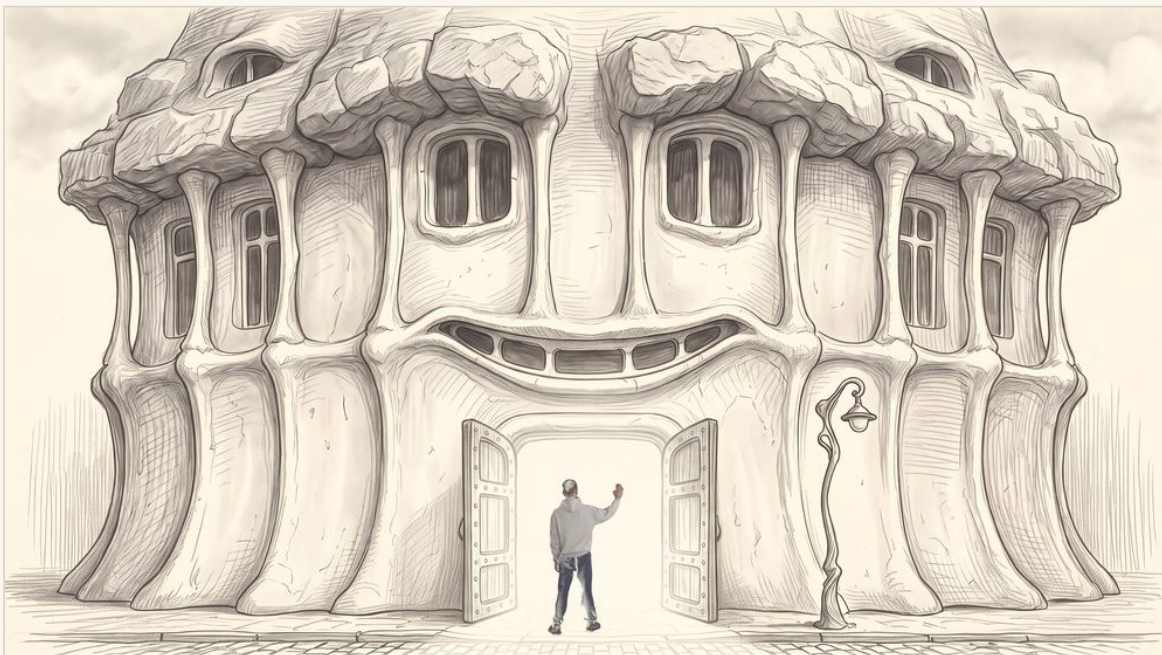
16-1-A-v1

16-1-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 16.2

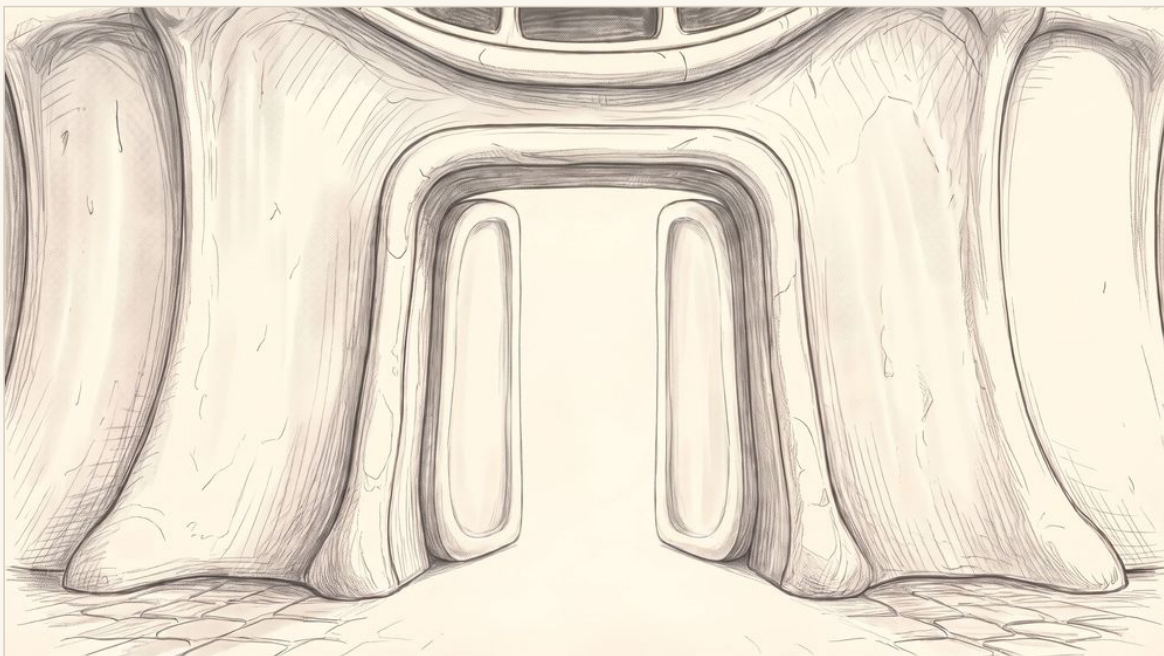
16-1-MOCKUP-v1

16-1-MOCKUP-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 17.0

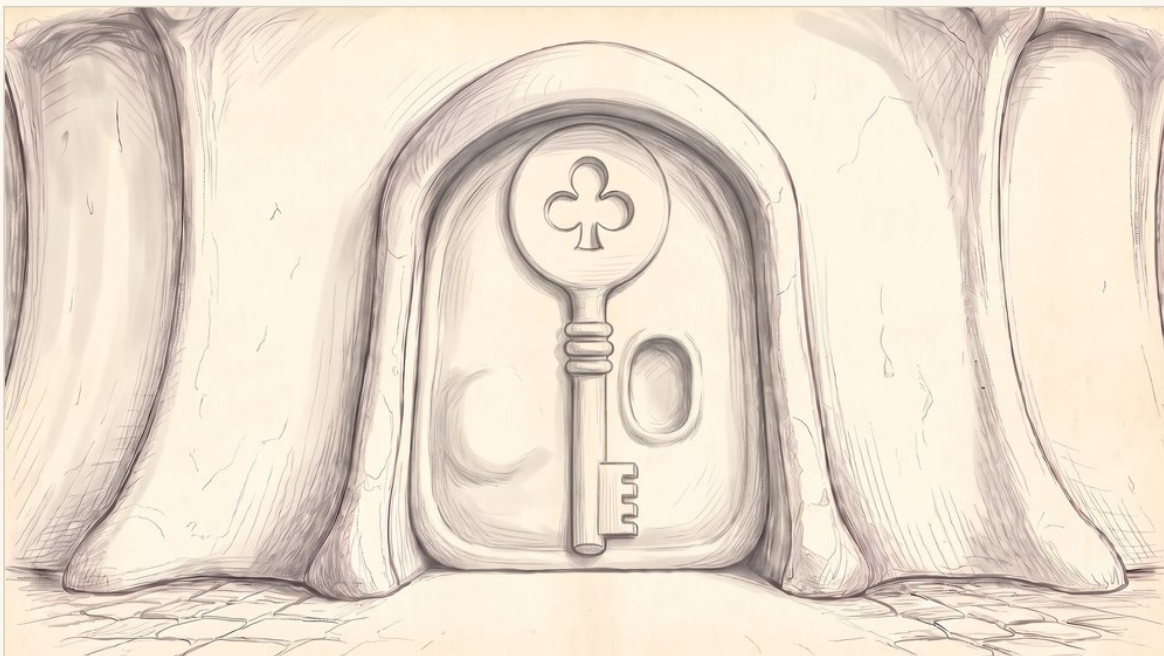
17-0-A-v2

17-0-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 18.0

The key door

18-0-A-v6.png

WHAT IT IS

COACH BRAIN is gone. A key raised in the clay running the whole height of the door, white on white, part of the door rather than attached to it. By now the audience has learnt to read the bumps, so nobody has to be told. Supersedes v5.

HOW IT MOVES

Hold, longer than is comfortable. Then in through the door, not around it. The key in the clay is the last thing on screen before the room.



PHASE 19.0

Coach Brain, and the first gold

19-0-A-v2.png

WHAT IT IS

He turns to look at us, and on a cord at his neck hangs the key. **THE FIRST GOLD IN THE FILM.** Gouache over pencil, the only painted thing on the sheet. It hangs small, worn rather than displayed. Supersedes v1.

HOW IT MOVES

Slow drift in on Coach Brain. He turns to us on his own time. The gold at his neck is the **ONLY** colour that has appeared in the film so far, so give it a beat with no other movement competing.



PHASE 19.1

19-1-A-v1

19-1-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

MANAN'S SIDE OF THE ROOM, AND IT IS A PLATE. Same control room as 6.3 from a new angle: console away on the left, screens above it, the closed riveted door on the right. THE WHOLE RIGHT HALF IS OPEN FLAGSTONE WITH NOTHING ON IT, because that is where Manan is keyed in from the grey backdrop footage, walking in through that door. He is never drawn. The chair is gone because Coach Brain is not in this shot yet: Manan arrives, asks what happened, and the answer comes after.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 19.2

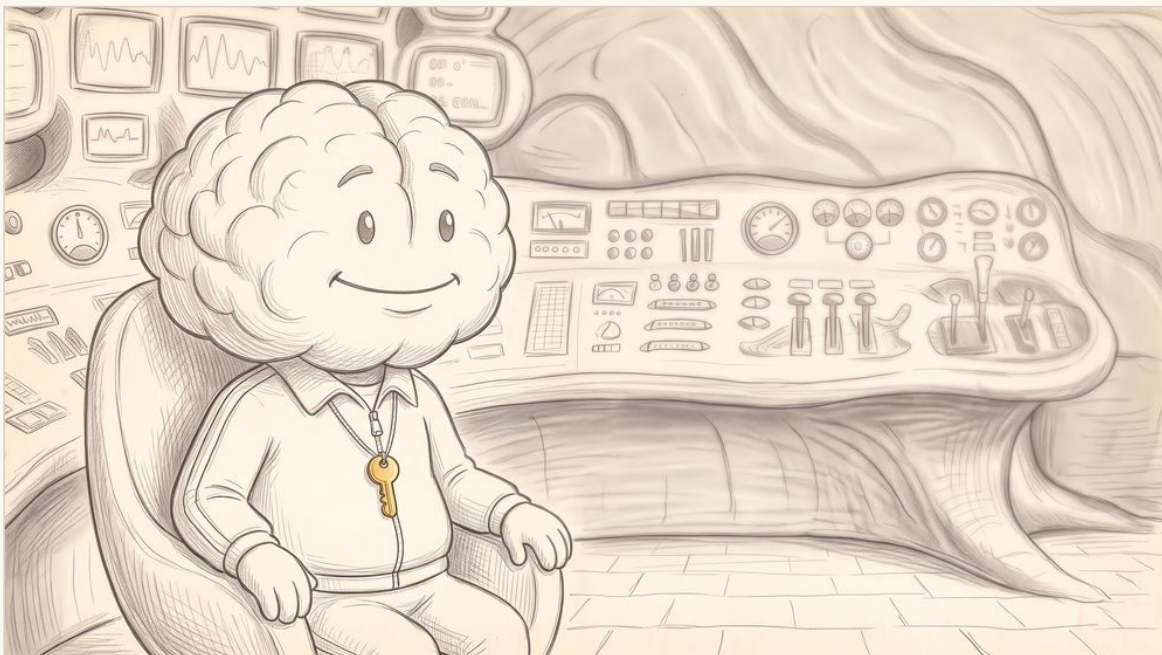
19-2-A-v1

19-2-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 19.3

19-3-A-v4

19-3-A-v4.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 19.4

19-4-A-v1

19-4-A-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 19.21

19-2-MOCKUP-v1

19-2-MOCKUP-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 19.41

19-4-MOCKUP-v1

19-4-MOCKUP-v1 . png

WHAT IT IS

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.2B

1-2b-v1

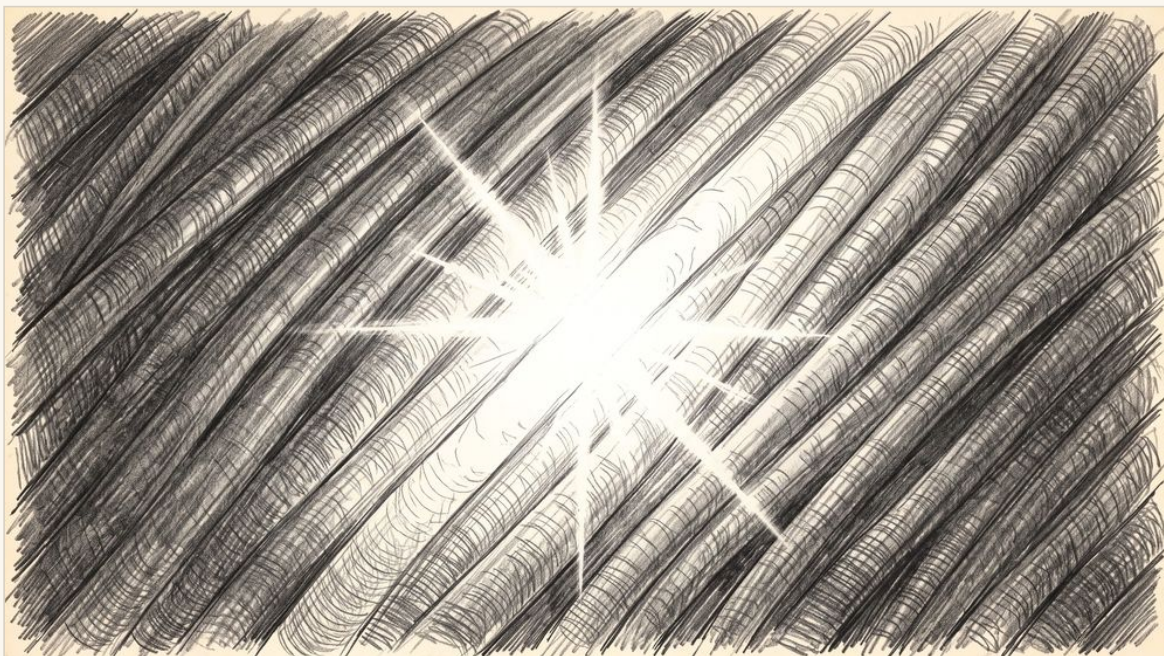
1-2b-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

What he sees. His subjective view down the avenue, the finish banner caught small in the gap between the trunks. This is the answer to the question the previous shot planted, and it is what explains the trees: he could not have seen it before, so his exhaustion was honest.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.2C

1-2c-1-v1

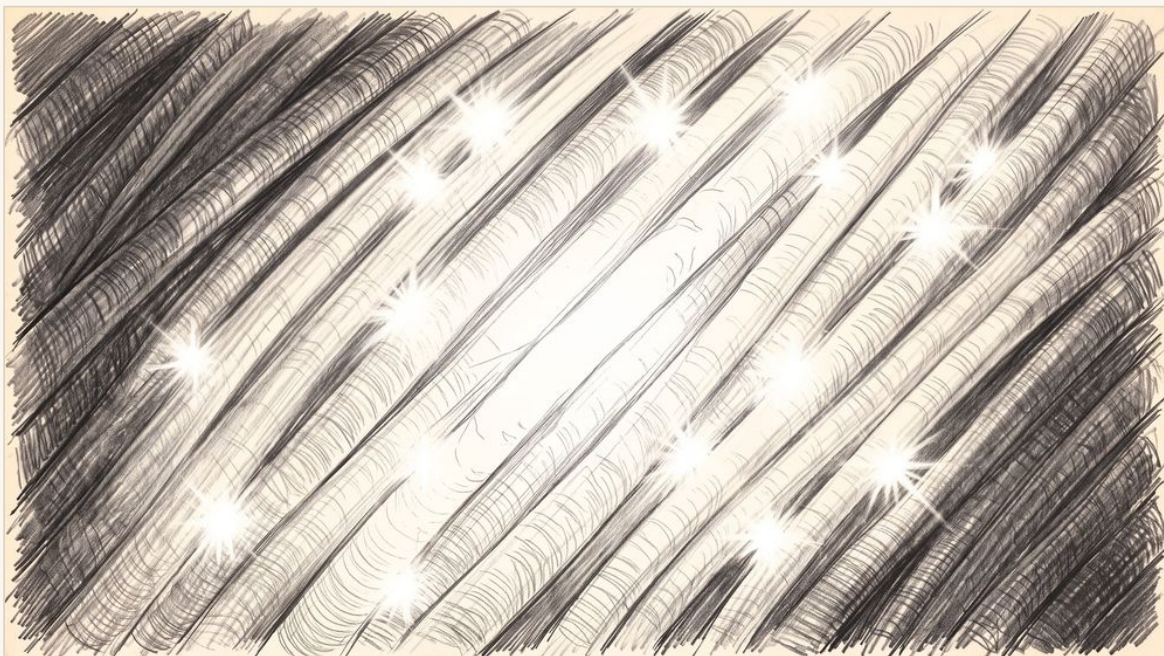
1-2c-1-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 1 of 4 of THE MUSCLE ACTIVATION. Deep inside a muscle, closer than any eye could get. One single fibre ignites and throws a hard star of light across the dark field; every other fibre is still unlit. THE DARKEST FRAME IN THE FILM, mean luminance 152 against about 240 everywhere else, and that darkness is what makes the light mean something. THIS SEQUENCE RUNS AT 25 FRAMES A SECOND, fully smooth, against 2 to 7 everywhere else. IT IS USED THREE TIMES IN THE FILM, the same files each time: here when the runner sees the finish line, again when Manan tries the bicycle, and again when Coach Brain names the limit. Never remake it for the other two, or the recognition dies.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.2C

1-2c-2-v1

1-2c-2-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 2 of 4 of the muscle activation. The fire spreads. A dozen ignition points along the same fibres, the fibres beneath them gone pale, the darkness pushed out to the corners. Same diagonal and same hand as key frame 1 on purpose: it has to read as recruitment spreading through one muscle, not as a cut to somewhere new. Measured escalation from key frame 1: mean luminance 152 to 185, bright pixels 16 percent to 33 percent. The light roughly doubles at each of the four beats.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.2C

1-2c-3-v1

1-2c-3-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 3 of 4 of the muscle activation. THE REVEAL. We pull back and what filled the frame turns out to have been one muscle in a leg. Every muscle now alight along its whole length. This is where the audience finally learns the scale they have been looking at, and where the field turns from the darkest frame in the film to the brightest. Measured across the three beats so far: mean luminance 152, 185, 235, bright pixels 16, 33, 71 percent. The leg is at rest rather than braced, which reads as charged and not yet released.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.



PHASE 1.2C

1-2c-4-v1

1-2c-4-v1.png

WHAT IT IS

KEY FRAME 4 of 4 of the muscle activation. The whole body, flayed, every muscle alight, caught pushing off into the sprint. The end of the sequence and the peak of the light. DISSOLVE FROM HERE INTO 1-3-A: the two frames are registered on purpose so the skin fades on with nothing moving. Mean pixel difference between them is 9.7 of 255.

HOW IT MOVES

First half grammar: it arrives by frottage, rubbed through the paper, never slid in and never faded up.